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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, September 17, 2020

Date	Thursday, September 17, 2020
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	3h 58m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Qy9_eTP40mg
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:56] Good morning, everybody that's just joining. I want to let you know that we are working on getting our live stream up on YouTube. You might see that it already says that, but we haven't quite connected it. So we will let everyone know once we're live.

[00:02:47] Good morning, everybody. For those of us, for those of you that are just joining, we are live streaming on YouTube a couple minutes before the meeting gets started. And we're just waiting for all of our board members and speakers to sign on.

[00:03:57] Good morning. good morning dan how are you thanks just making sure i you know we can be heard and all and can hear so that's great yes um we just to let those that are joining we are live on youtube um dan i'll pull down this share screen once we have everybody joined so everybody can see each other but i just for our youtube watchers i want them to know we're getting ready to get started perfect

[00:04:26] Thank you. Good morning, everybody. Good morning. Good morning. Good morning, Jamel. For those folks

[00:05:34] that are just joining us, we are live streaming on YouTube. We're just waiting for the remainder of our board members and panelists to jump on, and then we will get started. Good morning. Hi,

[00:06:05] Sonia. How are you? I'm doing good. Good. Just waiting for more folks to join in. We are live streaming on YouTube, and we'll get started in just a couple of minutes. Morning, everybody.

[00:06:23] Good morning. Great to see you this morning. Guys, I've got some unstable internet issues. So good to see you. Pam, it may help. When I have that, I often take my video down for a minute or two, and then it seems to stabilize. So if you keep having that problem, it might be the video.

[00:06:47] Okay, thanks. That's why you often see my video down during the meeting, because I get the unstable notification a lot good morning everybody we are live streaming on youtube and just waiting for the remainder of board members and panelists to join us um and we'll get started here in just

[00:07:16] a couple of minutes i see that dr aldridge is on yes he is dr aldridge i don't know if you can hear me this is jamel wilson just a quick note i was able to participate in the teachers in the movement uh conference a couple weeks ago and so wanted to thank you for that work and tell you how much i enjoyed it thank you for saying that i really appreciate it

[00:07:51] emily before we get started could i please say a very special thank you to everyone who participated on the panel yesterday um their comments stayed with me all evening and i was thinking about all of that so they made a big impact on my thought processes and i want to say thank you very much for the participation yeah absolutely as soon as we get started um i'm sure

[00:08:24] dan can turn the mic over to you for a couple of minutes and if i say no emily what happens then i mean i guess we're gonna have to stop the meeting and take controls away i do not want to take away from your agenda sir just any point everybody is looking well i told dr atkins that it's extra concealer on this morning because the puppy is up every 90

[00:09:04] minutes in the night time we still haven't seen him unless i missed it you haven't he is downstairs with my grandma well i understand your pet sitting but at an appropriate moment yeah all right well it is 10 o'clock so i'll go ahead and stop sharing my screen so we can actually see everybody um i think we have all of our board members here um and so president gecker i will turn it over to

[00:09:41] you thank you uh all right so i guess before i forget miss davis vaught you had some comments you wanted to make before we got started yes sir thank you very much i just would like to make sure that everyone who participated in yesterday's panel Dr. Carter from Smith County, Ms. Conger, Ms. Eck, Dr. Hutchinson and Dr. Kinsner know how very much I appreciate their participation yesterday and their thoughts resonated with me all evening and it's a very productive panel meeting about the SOA so thank you. Thank you for those comments and thank Dr. Pexton for her more than

[00:10:20] and able leadership of that committee and the work that's getting done there. It's really a pleasure to see how a well-organized committee runs. So thank you, Keisha. All right, we're gonna call the meeting of the Board of Education to order.

[00:10:37] Seems like just yesterday we did this, so it's good to be back. First, a roll call of the board members. Ms. Davis-Faught. - Present. - Dr. Turan. - Present. - Ms. Holton. - Present. - Dr. Mann, we've seen Tammy?

[00:10:58] - Present. - Ah, there we go. - Yes, sorry, I was on mute. - No, that's all right. It's hard for me to sort through the screen. Dr. Pexton? - Present. - And Dr. Wilson? - Present. - Great, first order of business then is approval of the minutes from July 22 and 23 meetings of the board.

[00:11:19] Has everybody had a chance to read them? And if so, is there a motion to adopt them as drafted or are there any changes or corrections desired? move to adopt the minutes. Thank you, Dr. Duran. Is there a second? A second. Thank you, Ms. Davis-Vaught. Roll call on all votes. Ms. Davis-Vaught? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye.

[00:11:47] Dr. Mann? Aye. Dr. Pexton? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. And chair votes aye. I will tell you, it will be none too soon that we get back to meeting in person. This is still a relatively awkward way to run a collegial meeting. Because we are virtual, we have a few things we want to say.

[00:12:10] Our meeting today is being streamed live on the VDOE YouTube channel and on the board's public meeting webpage. We'd like to welcome those joining us on the live stream from across the commonwealth. A couple of things to note about our virtual meeting. One, the board accepted written public comment for this meeting. All comments that were received by 5 pm yesterday have been uploaded to our meeting web page. Comments received after 5 p.m. will be provided to the board in a timely manner and posted on our meeting web page. Two, for our YouTube watchers, the chat feature is disabled as

[00:12:44] it is not monitored by staff. The best way to contact the board is via email at BOE, that's like Board of Education, at DOE, like Department of Education, dot Virginia dot gov. Since we are meeting virtually, as I noted before, there is a need for a roll call vote for each item.

[00:13:04] the staff asks that you speak clearly so that they can accurately capture your vote for the meeting minutes. Okay, that having been sent, I will say that the amount of public comment we received was fairly substantial this time on a variety of different topics.

[00:13:22] I've had an opportunity to look through all of them as I think most of the board members have by this point. We certainly appreciate the clear and concise discussion that we see in those emails regarding, you know, regarding the important topics of our day. We got a lot about the, you know, one of the topics for today, the African-American History Education Commission, quite a few about reopening schools and a number on the proposed changes to governor school admissions policies. So thanks to everybody who participates with us in that way.

[00:13:58] The consent agenda, is there a motion to either, well, motion to approve the entire consent agenda, or is there a desire to remove one or both of the items uh for discussion so motion to approve okay i heard dr duran motion to approve and i didn't see the second tammy mann second thank you thank you dr mann um all right vote on that miss davis bought hi dr duran hi miss holton she's trying to

[00:14:37] get herself on sorry i it goes back to the speak clearly and distinctly so that the staff can record your voting and unmute yourself yeah i should say that too thanks ann uh dr mann hi dr pexton hi dr wilson hi and i vote aye okay uh on to the action and discussion items uh item c final review of resolutions describing the standards of quality for public schools in virginia

[00:15:10] um assistant superintendent for policy equity and communications uh holly coy holly are you there she is on but her video does look frozen the moment so she may be having some connectivity good morning guys can you hear me now there she is wonderful sorry about that we've

[00:15:47] got three layers of mute here um well good morning president gecker dr lane and board members um this morning as as president gecker gecker mentioned i have the pleasure of presenting agenda item c to you which is the second review of the resolution prescribing the standards of quality that

you adopted last fall. This item was first presented back in July in a public comment window followed from August 2nd through 28th. Six comments were received and all supporting are with some recommendations for additional edits or refinements of the standards of quality.

[00:16:27] The recommendation today is to approve the resolution and direct staff to transmit the SOQs to the governor's office and to the General Assembly. I'd be happy to answer any questions you all might have on that item. Okay, are there any questions at this time? I will note again, just for people watching, that these SOQs are the same as we've described last year, fulfilling the constitutional mandate of the board to prescribe SOQs from time to time.

[00:16:59] they arise out of uh you know a few years of work in accordance with our comprehensive plan although invariably the press will report this as an issue of dollars in fact the standards of quality prescribed by the board represents slight changes in policy uh in particular an acknowledgement of how important teachers are to eventual outcomes uh the soqs if implemented would provide poorer school divisions with the ability to hire more experienced teachers and also provide

[00:17:33] a system of teacher mentorship as well as principal mentorship as we move forward. All important things in terms of changing the outcomes for the children in the commonwealth. With that as a summary, is there any discussion of the SOQ item? If not, is there a motion to adopt the resolution and then move this on to the legislature.

[00:17:59] - So moved. - So moved, President Gecker. - Thank you, Dr. Wilson, is there a second? - Second. - Thank you, is that Ms. Holton? - Yes. - Thank you, yeah. All right, roll call on this.

[00:18:14] Ms. Davis-Vaught. - Aye. - Dr. Duran. - Aye. - Ms. Holton. - Aye. - Dr. Mann. - Aye. - Dr. Pexton. - Aye. - Dr. Wilson. - Aye.

[00:18:29] - And I vote aye. I will also say that, you know, Although we didn't get a lot of traction last year, we didn't make it through the policy committees last year, we didn't make it through the money committees. The SOQs to me still are, that is this version of the SOQs, the marker for the future.

[00:18:48] And I firmly believe that as time goes on, the concepts embodied in these SOQs will be adopted by the legislature. And as we said, when we started this work, it may take a decade to get to where we wanna be, but I do believe that this marker is a good one and that, as I said, legislative policy will bend toward it over time.

[00:19:13] All right, item D, final review of proposed state-approved textbooks for K-12 science. Dr. Peterson. - Good morning, and I'm gonna go ahead and share my screen.

[00:19:28] And can you all see the PowerPoint? - I cannot yet. - I can see it. - It's coming up now, yeah, now I have it. - I'm in New Kent, and we're a little slow out here terms of delivery and service um good morning mr gecker members of the board and dr lane my name is ann peterson and i am science coordinator at the office of stem and innovation i'm here today with the vdoe science specialist myra thayer and gregory mcdougall to present feedback on the public comment review process and allow for a final review by the board of education

[00:20:06] on the proposed state approved textbooks list for k-12 science it is the responsibility of the board to approve textbooks for use in Virginia public schools. These approved textbooks align to the state's academic standards and are one resource that divisions may use when providing science instruction. The

current list of state approved science textbooks was approved by the board in 2012 following the adoption of the 2010 standard science standards of learning and curriculum framework. In September 2018, the board of education approved the 2018 science standards

[00:20:45] of Learning and Curriculum Framework. These standards in the Curriculum Framework were revised to provide students opportunities to engage in deeper learning through allowing greater student ownership in the discovery process and to provide opportunities for place-based learning. Place-based learning allows teachers to construct lessons that reflect the culture and community of the division, thus making science more relevant and accessible to students. Local school divisions are expected to fully implement the 2018 science standards of learning during the 2022-2023 school year

[00:21:23] and are awaiting for a board approved list in order to adopt and purchase necessary textbooks. In July, the Department of Education brought to the board a list of proposed science textbooks for initial review. A 30-day public comment period was advertised through a superintendent's memo, teacher direct science update and through virginia science organizations to provide stakeholders an opportunity to view the proposed textbooks and to provide feedback to the department of education at the request of the board of educational an additional level of scrutiny was applied to the

[00:22:00] proposed textbooks allowing stakeholders to provide feedback on the textbooks using an equity lens today the department of education is providing the board a summary of the feedback both from the public comment and the additional equity review process as the list of proposed k-12 science textbooks in addition to the k-12 science textbooks list for final review the 30-day public comment period allowed stakeholders the opportunity to review the proposed textbooks and to provide comments on these texts department of education received

[00:22:37] comments from 27 individuals in the state these individuals reflected teachers parents and science leaders a majority of these comments were positive responses to specific textbooks within a grade level comments overall were very positive and with only one negative comment concerning an older version of the proposed digital text at the request of the board of education at the july meeting the science team also conducted an additional review through the lens of equity to begin the process

[00:23:13] statements were generated whoops sorry i have uh three screens going on my neighbors say i look like a nasa station um here at home um at the request of the um board meeting in july we did the review through the equity lens to begin the process the statements were generated that focused on both equity and the videoe vision for science instruction these statements were reviewed by our board of supervisors and upon approval were placed in a survey that allowed respond reviewers to

[00:23:50] respond to the statements using a lichert scale opportunity was also provided to allow more in-depth comments the survey statements can be found in an agenda item appendix d once the survey was constructed the videoe team sought participants to conduct this review the textbook review team that was part of the initial review institutes of higher ed to include education and equity personnel from virginia commonwealth university the college of william and mary and the university of virginia and science supervisors from norfolk richmond and greensville were asked to be a part

[00:24:29] of this process 23 people were willing to conduct this extra layer of review and submitted a total of 162 responses i would personally like to thank those reviewers in taking time to provide feedback on this particularly during this time of year when divisions and teachers are working so hard to implement

instruction at the onset of a new academic year their responses can be found in appendix g the equity statements are provided on this slide the goal was to align the statements

[00:25:04] to the Virginia instructional vision the science instructional vision that is built into the 2018 science standards of learning the first statement was there are opportunities in the textbooks for students to view themselves their community and their cultural backgrounds in science the second statement the textbooks provide opportunities for teachers to design instruction that allows for students to engage in authentic science experiences and allows all students the opportunities to do science and develop scientific and engineering practices.

[00:25:38] The third statement, the nature of science reinforces the fact that science is an ongoing, collaborative, and society-driven endeavor that leads to the development and revision of scientific laws and theories. The textbook reflects the diversity of scientists and the impact of cultures involved in the development of scientific theories and laws, particularly those theories that are emphasized in the 2018 Science Standards of Learning.

[00:26:04] The final question was, would you recommend this textbook as a resource that teachers may use to address science content outlined in the 2018 Science Standards of Learning through the lenses of cultural, race, gender, and backgrounds of their classroom populations?

[00:26:24] In elementary, the images in the text overall were found to reflect opportunities for students to see themselves, their culture, and their community. Although at times, images of humans were limited. The focus of many of the images in some of the texts, particularly at the upper elementary grades, was on content.

[00:26:46] All texts provide opportunities for students to do science as they engage in scientific and engineering practices, and the nature of science was reflected in the books. However, this question was very difficult to address by some of the respondees because at lower grade level, students are only introduced to the tenets of the nature of science as cognitively appropriate for that age level.

[00:27:09] At the secondary level, many of the texts focused solely on science content. Images focused on concepts versus human images. As with elementary, there were opportunities to allow students to do science and engage in scientific and engineering practices were plentiful.

[00:27:28] At the conclusion of the secondary review, focused on equity, although all the reviewers indicated the textbooks should be approved based on science content, three of the middle school texts were scored low in terms of allowing students to see themselves their community and their cultures as well as not having opportunities to view scientists of different genders and cultures an additional review of all the middle school texts conducted by the video e-team and ann holton led to an in-depth analysis of the images and found that one textbook did not reflect the cultural diversity of our virginia population the science team has since reached out to the

[00:28:06] textbook publisher asking for revisions to the images to reflect more diversity and the publisher has agreed to update images to reflect a greater level of diversity with the intent of having a minimum of 30 to 40 percent of the images of humans to reflect people of color as well as increased gender diversity an anticipated timeline for this revision is expected by the end of this week the videoe team has had follow-up conversations with evaluators of texts at all grade levels where there were concerns areas of concern for the purpose of clarification aside from the one

[00:28:43] textbook stakeholders and the video science team did not yield anything that would prohibit books from being on the approved science textbook list next steps although it is important to have texts and other resources that reflect the cultures cultures and communities within virginia the video science team views these resources as a tool that teachers may use with instruction our goal is to provide teachers and leaders with an understanding that the tool alone does not ensure a classroom

[00:29:18] promotes deeper learning for all students. Our next steps are to provide professional development on how to use textbooks as well as resources in the development and implementation of quality science instruction. The quest for equitable science instruction for all students in Virginia must continue to be emphasized in all of our work moving forward. So thank you for your courteous attention and consideration the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board received for final review the attached list of

[00:29:54] proposed recommended textbooks for k-12 science are there any questions or any questions miss Holton thank you mr. president I first want to thank miss Peterson and her team and the reviewers that she enlisted particularly those from Norfolk and other school divisions who had a few other things on their plate uh in the last couple of months but who have really gone to extraordinary ends to review all of the proposed science textbooks in light of the feedback we gave to to them at our meeting in

[00:30:32] july and have just done an extraordinary extraordinarily thorough look uh at all of the proposed textbooks through an equity lens um and as ann as ann peterson said most of them had done a great job of presenting science through enabling students of all backgrounds to see themselves as scientists and to feel engaged in the work of science. We did the review that Ms. Peterson led did identify several textbooks that needed further scrutiny and one in particular

[00:31:10] that we felt just really was not acceptable. There weren't a whole lot of pictures of people at all and that's okay the science content was was prominent but there was some attention especially in sixth grade there should be some attention to introducing young people to careers in science and there were some there were a number of exemplars and there were it was frankly unacceptable in the diversity of the scientists presented in that textbook there were no no identifiable people of color among the scientists that I could find uh there were a handful of women uh but

[00:31:48] we know that our textbook publishers can and will do better with our encouragement uh and so with I I would like to uh propose that we that the board consider approving the textbook list with that one exception and it is the Virginia Elevate sixth grade textbook that needs revision the good news is that miss peterson has reached out to the publisher and they are eager to make those revisions and so i would propose that we approve the rest of the list today and come back for uh to look at that the revisions that the the publisher makes to that textbook

[00:32:24] next month with an eye towards approving it understanding that they're going to work to make sure that all students and particularly students of color and and young women see themselves as scientists. We need to counter the under-representation in STEM fields from those populations. So I appreciate the publisher's willingness to go the extra mile and get it right. The one other thing I know we talked about last month and I know Ms. Peterson and her team are working on, but we as a board should be sure and keep on our agenda is we

[00:32:58] need to revise our board approved criteria for reviewing textbooks to make this equity lends explicit right from the beginning so so that we don't end up having to play catch up the way Ms. Peterson

and her team have so ably done this time so that would be my comment Mr.

[00:33:19] Mr. President that I hope we can see our way to approve the textbooks but with that one exception today. I would view that as a comment and a motion perhaps. Happy to make a motion when the time is right or make it now if you prefer you get now that we'll do discussion is there a second to that and then we can have the discussion i second that mr president thank you dr geron okay now discussion on that president gecker i have a question uh for both dr peterson and miss holton so dr peterson i think i heard you say that the company is has agreed to come back by the end of

[00:33:56] this week with a timeline for when they would make the revisions not necessarily with the revisions completed by that time so the question so if you can clarify that and then if that is the case that they are coming back sooner with a timeline do we know what their plan is for completing the revisions that we are requesting and how does that then line up with miss holton's comment or motion that we would hold off reviewing or approving that one until our october meeting um in discussions

[00:34:32] with the textbook publisher uh contact that we have she has reached out to the instructional team uh their their format is digital allowing them a greater deal of speed and replacing images they are very concerned um that they want it done as soon as possible uh i into yeah we'll wait till the timeline comes with this just this discussion came up last night we have been in contact with them three times since last night and uh hopefully with that digital format will be faster and we can get it within the next month um they are in a hurry because they want their textbook represented

[00:35:11] um and you'll see that there's only two textbooks for sixth grade and the fear is that if a division accepts or adopts a series it will automatically eliminate their series so they're very on top of that but i in terms of the timeline we'll send it to you as soon as we get it thank you okay any other discussion on this we do have a motion and a second if i may just clarify my motion uh in light of dr wilson's remarks i i would propose that we approve without uh the virgin delegate

[00:35:47] elevate sixth grade today and that they that we invite the department to bring that one back for review when appropriate so not necessarily tying it hopefully it can be as soon as next month but whenever it's ready friendly amendment if i may okay and and you also had a request regarding changing the rubric i guess for review dr peterson how do we go about doing that um i'm going to have

[00:36:23] to uh defer to my boss mr bowling good morning all um we certainly will uh take that uh those comments back certainly we want to improve our process however we we will be having discussions with the board regarding the approval of high quality instructional materials as we move forward versus just textbooks and so because they come in many different formats so that certainly the equity lens will certainly be a part of any approval process as we move forward. Good but Mr. President

[00:37:02] if I may Michael and Ann it's my understanding what you all shared with us last month that we do have a document that is i think board approved that is the criteria that we use for textbook approval and that there was nothing in it explicitly with an equity lens and so isn't that there is a document that formally guides the process and shouldn't we be uh pulling that up and and what do we need to do yes and and and if we continue using that document as the main driver

[00:37:35] of any kind of approval process for instructional materials then certainly we will update that and change that or propose changes to that process prior to its use in the future. The next set of standards that has to approve textbooks won't come until after the history and social sciences standards are

approved and that process does not start until 22. I hear you that we may not be using that specific document again but the sooner we can we can be clear in

[00:38:13] our signaling to all the publishers what our expectations are on all of the materials we're going to be using and the clearer we can be either through revising that criteria document or otherwise the better absolutely will do in the interim I don't think I've seen that document although you'll probably tell me it was attached to an agenda item sometime but would you mind sending the rubric to the board so we have it in front of us. And, you know, let's put together a timeline

[00:38:46] for making changes to it, you know, rather than just putting it on hold until 22, if that's all right. Dr. Lane, is that okay with you? Yes, Mr. Gecker, I was going to chime in. Our plan is to have this new review process to you well before the history and social studies standards are completed and so I think you can count on that being in the first part of the new year but I'll we'll put together a timeline for next month okay thank you very much all right we have a motion in the second to approve all but one again

[00:39:23] by roll call Dr. Susan Davis-Vaugh aye Dr. Duran aye Ms. Holton aye Dr. Mann aye Dr. Pexton aye Dr. Wilson aye and I vote aye thank you very much Ms. Peterson or Dr. Peterson Thank you.

[00:39:49] Okay. Item E is something we've all been waiting for, the report from the Governor's Commission on African American History Education in Virginia. As the agenda item notes, the commission was formed by Executive Order 39 on the 24th of August of 2019.

[00:40:09] So to have as, you know, complete a report before us as we do today is sort of light speed for any commission. So we are all very impressed and would like to know how you did it. We have with us as presenters, Dr. Rosa Adkins, who was Commission Chair and Superintendent of Charlottesville City Schools, Dr. Cassandra Newby-Alexander, Commission Co-Chair and Belief Chair of the Standards Review Committee and Dean of the College of Liberal Arts and Professor of History at Norfolk State, and Dr. Derek Ulrich, Co-Chair, Professional Development

[00:40:45] Committee and Professor of Education and Director of the Center for Race and Public Education in the South at the University of Virginia. So welcome to the three of you and we look forward to hearing from you. - Thank you. Dr. Lane, board member present, President Gecker, thank you for having us.

[00:41:06] We appreciate you allowing us to present before you today. And the speed at which this was done came because of many late nights, long days, and long weekends. So we appreciate being before you today. Thank you.

[00:41:24] know they're pulling up the slides now thank you on august the 25th 2019 governor rath northram signed executive order 39 establishing the commission on african-american history education the commission was tasked with thoroughly examining the k-12 curricula in order to improve the way african-american history is taught in virginia schools commission members included university professors, school superintendents, historians, school board members, faith leaders,

[00:42:03] teachers, and many other critically important perspectives. The commission began in fall of 2019 and over the course of the following year met seven times and the commission was intentional in selecting locations in different parts of the commonwealth so that all perspectives could be represented subcommittee members met in between the four commission meetings to develop draft

[00:42:36] recommendations this is a historical moment that has been given to us a unique opportunity to reaffirm our commitment to breaking down monumental inequities and to tell a truer better and more honest Virginia history story. Black history is Virginia history. Ultimately, the Commission's recommendations will help Virginia students develop a comprehensive understanding of the African-American voices that contribute to Virginia society.

[00:43:13] Virginia's standards of learning must be inclusive of African-American contributions, culture and accomplishments and provide opportunities for students to engage deeply in its richness allow them to draw conclusions to its relevance to our contemporary communities and closing knowledge gaps for all age groups and ethnicities as students are presented with this history they will wrestle with the ways in which black and brown virginians were disenfranchised

[00:43:51] marginalized, and oppressed from the time of the first African-American arriving at Old Point in 1619. To better understand African-Americans, how they found ways to survive, to preserve our culture and our families, and to help build a flourishing Virginia society. We believe that the recommendations made by the commission will result in curriculum changes that allow Virginia students thoroughly examine and directly combat systemic racism in the commonwealth's history

[00:44:31] in order to work towards a better society and better educated citizens and a better virginia students will be educated to appreciate the fact that african americans have made valuable contributions to society in virginia and the united states if we get this right american history african-american history will move from being a season to being threaded throughout a continuous

[00:45:05] study of the commonwealth of virginia therefore giving a deeper understanding of the black ancestors and greater empathy for all neighbors and all of the citizens of the commonwealth we received many comments and input the commission held listening sessions throughout the commonwealth and during those listening sessions over 300 attendees provided comment those sessions were

[00:45:39] held in roanoke richmond and norfolk i'll draw your attention to one recent comment that we received the commission received from the virginia legislative black caucus delegate bagby the recommendations of the commission are timely and critically important to ensuring that virginia's public schools are inclusive learning environments for black students and that Virginia's educators and curriculums accurately reflect the true history and contributions of African Americans

[00:46:19] to modern-day America. There's an urgency associated with these recommendations. The Black Legislative Caucus is thankful for all of the work that has been done and the prioritizing of the review and approval of these recommendations to ensure that students are able to benefit from these changes in this academic year a legislative black caucus also will provide any support that

[00:46:52] we might need and include any any initiatives as appropriate in the 2020-21 legislative agenda so we want to thank the board for hearing this presentation today and we look forward with working with the board and the commission to continue to discuss and move these initiatives forward dr cassandra alexander newbriel alexander thank you thank you so much dr atkins could we

[00:47:28] uh advance the slides please thank you so much uh to the next slide so all of you know that Virginia has been a leader in so many things, including the birth of America. And I'm very grateful that Governor Ralph Northam recognized how Virginia needed to also be a leader in our educational system, understanding that knowledge must rest firmly on the foundation of truth.

[00:48:05] By establishing the Commission on African American History Education, it was Governor Northam's vision that Virginia would continue that legacy of pioneering a path forward. This legacy, however, would not resemble glossing over the past wrongs that were also a part of Virginia's legacy. Rather, his directive was to ensure that all of Virginia's youth were educated to understand his history and the legacies of past wrongs that included segregation, discrimination, slavery, as against

[00:48:43] a significant part of our population, as well as Virginia's monumental contributions to American society. And as co-chair of this commission, my role was to lead the standards subcommittee that included recommending technical edits, the standards review process, and the framework for future standards of learning that were accurate and inclusive. The latter is critical because American historians are focused on revising the narrative throughout America

[00:49:17] to be inclusive, accurate, and balanced. And without these standards being proactive, we will actually be behind the curve when it comes to educating our students to understand their shared history, their shared past. In fact, in Virginia, the lines are very blurred, even racially, as most of you probably know. And so to see this as our shared past is critically important.

[00:49:50] And if we could go to the next slide. While much progress has been made with the standards of learning more is needed to extract the political agendas from the retelling of history. And most of that history is from what historians call the master narrative that presents history in a very narrow perspective. Instead, the narrative should be richer and more expansive in talking about our shared past. And the listening group that was in Norfolk included a number of high school

[00:50:28] students who were very diverse who all said the same thing that the more expansive their knowledge and understanding of history is the more engaged they are in learning about that history in knowing about that history because they know that the current narrative is very limiting and it is stifling in so many ways so when the commission was first convened we were told that the standard practice by the department of education was to define the technical edits use using the following

[00:51:03] standards that there would be a correction of inaccurate information that there will be a clarification and editing of incomplete statements and that there will be a revision of grammatical errors and this is what we engaged in the next slide the technical edits working group was led by distinguished scholar dr ed ayers and you will know from our report that the technical edits presented to you resulted from considerable discussion in fact care was taken extreme care

[00:51:38] was taken by the entire subcommittee so that we were in line with the guidelines provided to us by the doe when we were going over the technical edits that were first presented to us by dr ayers Our discussions also included a DOE official who advised us when we had questions regarding those technical edits so that we were in line with the guidelines. Indeed, even the inclusion of a section of the technical edits on lynching was designed to provide clarification on the incomplete

[00:52:18] statements regarding the impact Jim Crow had on not only African Americans but on the entire commonwealth and indeed the nation at large. And so as you can see the technical edits work group looked at and summarized their recommendations as you can see. They looked at the elementary level language that was changed to make sure that it was more inclusive, that it covered diverse backgrounds. It highlighted not just American neighborhoods that have, in so many of the

[00:52:55] illustrations and examples, left out African American neighborhoods so that people, the young people especially, could understand that our history should be and needs to be inclusive.

[00:53:11] There were important figures that were included that had diverse perspectives. The master narrative often defines African Americans in a monolithic way. African Americans are both male and female. They are both heterosexual and homosexual. They are also both rich and poor, middle class, upper middle class, all different levels. It is not a monolithic approach. And so we wanted to make sure that the historical figures that were included were more than just this

[00:53:48] monolithic approach or standard perspective so that the students could really engage but more importantly they could see these individuals in their own communities because we know that when young people identify that they can see the path where they live then they can identify with the history that's being taught in the classrooms we also wanted to make sure that the terms that were

[00:54:16] included were not only accurate, but relevant. Next slide, please. If we could go to the next slide, that would be helpful. Thank you. So when we also looked at the standards, we wanted, we knew that it would be a challenge, and this is, go back to the previous slide, that it would be a challenge

[00:54:52] to approach um the um revisions from just a general sort of standard way that uh historians and textbooks have done it usually it's just chronological but it focuses on the wealthy elite white men and we wanted to make sure that people had a different understanding for example the majority of people who came to Virginia, whether it was by force or it was voluntary,

[00:55:26] they were not free. And to talk about freedom from the various lenses was critically important and it would help people to understand their true history. And so we looked at 10 key concepts that are listed here to talk about our history our shared past so that there would be inclusivity but also accuracy and we also included the definition so that teachers knew how to teach

[00:55:59] these concepts and how those frameworks should be presented to the young people next slide please so in the standards overhaul work group we not only looked at that but we also looked at the process for revisions and we recommended um that um that there be a revision or elimination of the standards that are inaccurate or out of date and that there should be funds secured for professional

[00:56:32] development to in to equip educators to teach to these new standards and so um one of the things that uh we believed was critically important was the need to educate our educators because so many have not had this diverse educational background that people like me um i i am a professor of history and I teach especially African-American and American history and that is my field also in which I publish and so a lot of people don't know this particular history because it's not included

[00:57:12] in older textbooks now of course a lot of new textbooks include a lot of this history and so many of our teachers especially in the field of social studies typically are a little older than some of the other fields and their educational life did not include a lot of what is now being included and so a lot of professional development we believe was necessary the next slide please

[00:57:40] the next slide please the slide advanced dr newby i'm sorry just wanted to make sure you all were seeing the slide yes yes so um the pro the process revision work group which was also part of our subcommittee uh pointed out there were things that we we thought was really needed and we made the

[00:58:14] following recommendations to expand the number of educators and external content experts so that rather than there be a reaction to the standards already developed that at its inception that the development occur and we feel that this is critically important and and just on a personal note i've actually reviewed the standards after they were already developed um and i had so many comments that that um i guess you could fill a book because there were so many inaccuracies

[00:58:50] presented in those standards and i know my fellow historians who were also reviewing it had the same comments so if you have the experts right there at the formation of the standards that would help to ensure that the standards are following the the not only the current um um perspectives and articulations of historians but it is grounded in historical fact um the other thing is we wanted to make sure we recommended that there be a steering committee comprised of external content

[00:59:29] people who would and practitioners who would review and revise the content recommended and then to encourage outreach from parents students educators across the commonwealth we think it's critically important because many parents don't know this history either and so it is an opportunity for them to learn and to grow as well and then to ensure that all commons perspectives are examined, reviewed, and of course the content is again reviewed, and then to secure funds to expand

[01:00:07] educator and external committees so that once again there's an additional level of revision. Next slide, please. And so I'm going to yield to my other co-chair, Dr. Derek Aldridge, who will talk about the professional development subcommittee. Thank you so much. Thank you, Dr. Nubi Alexander, Dr. Atkins, for your presentations. Let me just say that it was an honor to serve as the co-chair

[01:00:43] of the commission with my esteemed co-chairs. And as a former middle school and high school social studies and history teacher, I can't think, I mean, this was the perfect commission for me, subcommittee for me to co-chair. Prior to joining the commission, I received an email from a former student of law, and I would like to just provide you with a small quotation from that email. She said, "As a first-year educator, I am finding that I'm running into racial and cultural issues in the workplace. In efforts to educate myself and be proactive, I was wondering if you had any reading

[01:01:21] for educators regarding race and ethnicity i want to learn more about the black child's experience in schools today and this was a very this is a very important email and i and i keep it uh on my phone all the time to remind me of the importance of teachers uh gaining the right type of training and professional development as it pertains to african-american history education So let's move to the next slide. Second on here. All right. So the professional development subcommittee

[01:02:00] developed six priority legislative recommendations that I want to talk with you about today. And they were in the areas of culturally relevant teaching and gaining foundational knowledge in African-American history. Next. And after much debate, going back and forth and consultation with uh members of the commission as well as uh individuals across the commonwealth we came up with these um six recommendations first revised virginia's teacher evaluation regulation and

[01:02:38] regulations and virginia's uniform performance standards for school leaders uh to include cultural proficiency um i can't express how many i mean how many emails can't tell you how many emails i received from school leaders across uh the commonwealth uh asking me to make sure that we included uh school leaders in our recommendations so we wanted to put that very at the very front uh mainly because if these school leaders uh gain proficiency uh and cultural cultural relevancy then it will make it very easy it will make it much easier for uh their teachers to gain this

[01:03:18] um professional development number two require every virginia educator to certify that they have enrolled in cultural competency professional development by 2022 uh and that's right around the corner but we this just gives you a sense of how important we thought this was uh number three very important allocate funding and personnel resources to development implement comprehensive professional development uh in the areas of african-american history content and cultural competency for Virginia educators, because without funding, we all know that this will not occur.

[01:03:55] So we wanted to place this recommendation at the very top or near the top of our list. Number four, mandate certification, continuing education units, and African-American history for all holders of education licenses issued by the Virginia Department of Education.

[01:04:13] And this includes initial licensure and renewals. Number five, we suggest that we amend requirements for licensure endorsements in history and social science to require evidence of course study in African-American history, a very important recommendation.

[01:04:34] And last one that we debated quite a bit, probably more than any other one of our recommendations, is the requirement of a credit in African-American history as a new requirement for graduation Virginia. And the new elective course in African-American history developed by BDOAE and WHRO could be used to fulfill this requirement. So these are our six legislative recommendations.

[01:05:03] Next slide. We also believe that there should be minimum criteria established for state approval of professional development in the following areas: culturally relevant teaching, cultural proficiency, culturally responsive teaching, anti-racist education, and African-American history.

[01:05:25] Our subcommittee divided our work into four quadrants, and those quadrants include culturally responsive schools, culturally responsive leadership, culturally responsive educators, and culturally responsive pedagogues. I'm going to list out or discuss a few of those recommendations within those quadrants. For culturally responsive schools, we believe that

[01:06:00] these schools should be safe, inclusive, and secure environments where all students are affirmed, that they should provide universal access to culturally relevant pedagogy that build positive cultural identities, and that these schools should have systems in place to mitigate racial or cultural tensions. We have this full list in the report, and these slides will be available to you if you want to view the others. But those are three from the Cultural Responsive

[01:06:30] Leadership Quadrant. Next. Next slide. That's the next slide. It advanced a little quicker than I thought it would. Okay. All right. Cultural Responsive Leadership. One was to deploy resources and professional learning opportunities to advance cultural proficiency. In terms of leadership we believe that leaders should establish high expectations for all students that they should also ensure recruitment and retention of teachers of color and demonstrable

[01:07:09] cultural responsive competencies very important and that school leaders should create caring learning communities where heritages uh are valued the diversity of heritage are next well culturally responsive educators uh in this quadrant um we put forth the idea that the that culturally responsive educators should reflect on their own cultural lens not just on the cultural lens of their students but their own cultural lens in in their pedagogy that they

[01:07:44] should model high expectations for all students uh and that they should recognize and redress bias in the system and i also would like to uh state that we also believe it's very important that they

communicate in linguistically and culturally responsive ways and we believe that recommendations that we have put forth will help tremendously in this area.

[01:08:13] And then we have culturally responsive teaching and pedagogy. And we established a three-pronged approach in institutional, personal, and instructional. In terms of the institutional, we want to recognize a need for reform of school policies.

[01:08:31] Next, personal, require teachers to become culturally responsive. And last, instructional, provide educational materials that are culturally affirming. and that aid in delivering culturally responsive instruction okay next next slide here on the next slide okay um student oriented uh is another component of the teaching uh culturally responsive

[01:09:09] teaching and pedagogy and we also believe that it should identify and nurture students cultural strengths to promote student achievement and that diverse groups from all rings of culture should be represented, validated, and affirmed.

[01:09:32] So some of the highlights from our general recommendations are to broaden the teaching pipeline to seek out and train a diverse group of teachers. Very important. Develop models for training about implicit bias and culturally responsive pedagogy.

[01:09:50] And last would be to develop guidelines for culturally responsive teaching and culturally responsive practice in Virginia. And we have the other recommendations listed as well that you can view.

[01:10:05] And last, I would like to end with the words of Ralph Ellison, which he said, "If you can show me how I can cling to that which is real to me while teaching me a way into the larger society, then and only then will I drop my defenses and hostility, and I will sing your praises and help you to make the desert bear fruit."

[01:10:29] Desert bear fruit, thank you. Thank you to our co-chairs for your wonderful presentation. We appreciate it. We'd like to thank the board for allowing us to present to you today.

[01:10:45] And we will be here to answer any questions, Mr. Gecker, that you might have or any of the board members. - Thank you very much. First, thanks to the three of you for being with us today and sharing with us the important work that you all have been doing.

[01:11:00] I think you know that next on our agenda is the beginning of the process of certain revisions and that the commission has recommended. But before I speak, I guess I'll open it to the board members. Anybody have any questions or comments?

[01:11:18] Dr. Duran? - Yes. First, I just wanna say thank you, Dr. Atkins, Dr. Aldridge, Dr. Nubi Alexander for a great presentation. It's time that we are addressing this and I'm glad that your leadership has done that in a very quick way. You know, African-American history is American history and we need to be teaching it that way.

[01:11:38] Traditionally, it's been limited as you talked about, I'm sure in your committee to slavery or civil rights area only. And that's just certainly part of the story, but it certainly limits all students to learning about the vastness and the greatness of the African-American culture and the contributions.

[01:11:54] And so I really thank you for your leadership in that, the 10 key concepts of what really resonated with me to how we can ensure that African-American history not segregated and is really taught as all of our history and making sure that we're eliminating any inaccurate standards and doing what we

need to help all students learn what all of our history is really about. We've not told our full history and so what you have done and the work you've done has helped put us on that path here in Virginia to be able to tell everyone's history and not limit it to certain portions or parts that people have felt comfortable to share and not recognize and

[01:12:33] valued all the parts that should have needed to have been shared all this time so i really want to just commend you and thank you for that and look forward to seeing how we can support from the state board any efforts to do that i think the key one thing you mentioned a couple of times is the professional development that will be needed to help teach these new standards and how do we support our leaders from superintendent school board members even all the way down to the classroom to really change that concept because unfortunately i think that it is one that is ingrained in our culture for quite some time that it's a segregated history and the way u.s history has

[01:13:10] been defined for us is not been really holistic and inclusive of everyone and so i'm really really thankful for the work you've done and i commend you for serving in those roles and presenting today so no questions but really want to just thank you because it's a time that we teach african-american history as american history anybody else on the board president gecker yes Dr. Wilson. Thank you. I will echo Dr. Duran's thanks and comments and didn't want the opportunity

[01:13:47] to go by without my saying a special thank you to the commission, all members of the commission, each of the three subcommittees. The time, Dr. Atkins, that you mentioned in your opening comments, how did you get it done so quickly? The dedication of the time and the expertise that's represented certainly by the commission co-chairs or subcommittee chairs as well as all of the membership and I have been spending a bit of time walking through the report itself and am very thankful and appreciative of the the work that's represented there so that's all I have President Gecker just

[01:14:26] to thank you thank you Dr. Wilson it's hoping that I see you beginning to speak yes thank you I echo the thanks to the Commission members and the chairs with us today thank you all you all given us a lot to work on obviously your recommendations many of them go to the legislature and and other entities but a lot of them are directly within our purview at the board and we're going to start working on them with our next agenda item today others of your recommendations will be relevant as we look at the history sol revisions coming up in 2022

[01:15:05] and as we wrestle with uh uh professional development teacher evaluation uh uh leadership standards in other contexts so we will take these recommendations to heart over uh both today but also in years coming i i'll just say on a personal level i i've just uh you know despite lots of effort to get things right. We're learning just how much we still have to do. And I personally have learned so much in reading in the last few years, understanding, you know, I was vaguely

[01:15:41] aware of Jim Crow and its impacts, but just understanding just how pervasive the Jim Crow constraints were on our African-American communities right up through the 60s and, you know, deliberate actions by state, federal, and local governments with continuing impacts today on wealth, direct connection to wealth gaps and income gaps today that then in turn have direct impact on educational success. And so, and I'm at a product of Virginia public

[01:16:17] schools. My kids all came through public schools and, you know, we've, we've, we've tried to get some things right in the past, but we have a lot more work to do. And you all really help highlight it uh and it will make a difference for kids for a long time to come so i thank you mr gecker yes i would i would like

to add to i can't improve upon on any of the statements but i echo all of the statements and everyone spoke so eloquently about this i'm very impressed with the comprehensive

[01:16:49] nature of the review and thank you very much for also adding that there's going to be a need for for training and outreach of our parents as well, because that's an important piece of this. So thank you to Dr. Adkins, Dr. Newby-Alexander, and Dr. Aldridge for this very comprehensive look, and thank you very much.

[01:17:10] We will move forward on this, and I'm so happy to be a part of this. - Good comments, Dr. Paxton? - Yeah, I won't do the broken record, but here, here. But I did actually have a question, maybe for Dr. Adkins, 'cause it was when you were presenting, but on slide 16, when you were going over the recommendations, or maybe I'm sorry, that might've not been Dr. Atkins.

[01:17:38] I think that was Dr. Aldrich. On number six, you kind of made a comment about the discussion around that and how interesting it was. And I was just wondering, or maybe involved it was, and I'm just wondering if maybe you could expand on that a little bit more, just for my- - Can you jump in flat again?

[01:18:10] - Dr. Aldrich decided that it's number six on legislative recommendations.

[01:18:26] - Yes, so there was quite a bit of conversation with members of our subcommittee about whether there would be space in the curriculum to require this for graduation.

[01:18:42] I mean, to require a credit in African-American history for graduation. And we decided not to get, ultimately not to get into details of how that will be worked out. And to just stick with the fact that we thought that it should be a requirement given the contributions and the significance of African-Americans in the Commonwealth of Virginia historically.

[01:19:07] So that's what the conversation revolved. - So it was more a matter of the discussion, the debate was around where would it fit or how would we make it work, not whether or not it should be. - No, no, no, we were unanimous in that.

[01:19:23] It was just a, and it was also a question about, how that would be received in different parts of the state. But we were all in agreement that it should be a requirement. - Okay, thank you. - Okay, I don't see any other- - One question?

[01:19:43] - Yes, Dr. Mann. - One additional question, and of course, I echo the sentiments that have already been expressed. And I actually was listening quite, I've been listening quite intensively. and of course, digging into the materials. And I think Dr. Nubi-Alexandra, when you were speaking about sort of the frame that you all were using to make decisions about edits and such, one of the things you mentioned was out of date, sort of using the frame of what's out of date.

[01:20:18] And that struck me, and I really wanted to kind of appreciate that in the context of a conversation on history. I'm sure when we get into the technical edits, there may be opportunities to kind of unpack that, but I did want to kind of understand that a little bit.

[01:20:35] Inaccurate, I definitely get. - You said out of date, the reference to out of date material? - Inaccurate or out of date. - Yes, so let me give you an example of out of date.

[01:20:53] we just completed the 400th anniversary of the first landing of Africans, specifically those from the kingdom of Ndongo in the Angolan region to Point Comfort, which was part of the Virginia colony.

And one of the things that we were trying to disseminate to everyone is this idea that, first of all, it was not in Jamestown, Jamestown Colony, or the city, the little town of Jamestown,

[01:21:31] uh, that for a long time, the entire area that the English were claiming to control was called Jamestown. Um, but then by 1619, you would start to see it called Virginia. Um, and so that, that out-of-date information about exactly where you're talking about uh which is also inaccurate but it's it's out of accurate it it's out of date is important another one has to do with um this

[01:22:03] notion of the arrival of dutch ships and and so the the out-of-date information is this understanding that they had a dutch registry but they were actually english ships the two ships that arrived were owned one was the treasurer and was owned by the virginia company of london or the excuse me the london company of virginia and the other one was owned by one a duke i believe in england so they were both owned by england but they had a dutch registry so it's out of date uh in our

[01:22:42] understanding of this process that actually went on to call it a dutch ship and and so there's some accuracy in saying it had a dutch registry but it is inaccurate to call it a dutch ship so both of those things often work in concert with each other when you're talking about inaccurate or out-of-date information because some information has come to the forefront. Another example is 20, 20 Africans. No, historians have found there were 32 who arrived and they arrived within a few

[01:23:21] days of each other. The ships were separated by a storm and so just to say in 1619-20 arrived is not only inaccurate but it is out of date with recent scholarship that said maybe there were 20 that initially arrived probably about 22 but then there were others who arrived later on and so that's why the two phrases the two words are in concert or in tandem with each other because we know that historians are always looking back on some of the documents to get a refresh view.

[01:24:01] They're also pulling documents together that weren't there before, that, you know, were scattered in different archives. For example, John Thornton and Linda Haywood did a look, a real examination, not just of the English documents, but the Spanish documents and the Portuguese documents to find that the original Africans were from the Kingdom of Ndongo. And so that's what I mean. I hope I've kind of given you enough examples to clarify what those two terms mean. Thank you.

[01:24:35] That's very, very helpful. Thank you so much for that. Thank you. Okay, I think that covers the comments and I will echo without repeating the praise that the rest of the board has you know heaped upon y'all for the work we thank you for it and we frankly appreciate your spending the time today with us i know you thanked us a number of times for allowing you to be here i mean the truth is uh we are very thankful that the three you know distinguished folks such as yourselves could spend this much time with us uh and you know talk to us about what you've been doing and we look forward to working with you in the future

[01:25:15] so thank you all very much okay uh we will move on to item f uh first our first review of the recommendations detectable edits uh i think this is uh dr lane is that right mr gecker thank you it's brown i'm sorry i need to turn the page on my cheat sheet that they give me sometimes it's okay mr i'm very sorry well good morning good morning mr gecker

[01:25:54] um dr wilson members of the board dr lane um my name is christonya brown i am the history and social science coordinator here at the virginia department of education and it is my honor to have the opportunity to discuss with you the work compiled by the video team regarding the recommendations

from the standard subcommittee of the governor's commission on african-american in history, education in Virginia.

[01:26:28] I want to first acknowledge the hard work and tremendous amount of time and dedication of the standard subcommittee led by Dr. Cassandra Nubi-Alexander. And I do want to stress the amount of time and tremendous hard work put in by this team.

[01:26:49] I would also like to acknowledge the work and support from the VDOE team, which was comprised of Dr. Lane and his senior leadership staff. Also staff from the departments of learning and innovation, policy, equity, and communication, and the student assessment team, who collectively reviewed the recommendations from the subcommittee to compile the documents outlining the recommended edits.

[01:27:22] this morning with a presentation. And Emily, should I share my screen or would you like to share yours? - Kristani, it is up to you. Happy to do either way. It may be easier if you control, but you tell me what works.

[01:27:38] - I can do that. - Okay. - Can everyone see that? - Yes, I think we can, thank you. - Thank you.

[01:27:56] So this morning with the presentation, I would like to take you briefly through the timeline of the work from the standard subcommittee the work group a discussion of the two categories that staff carefully considered for each recommended edit and finally the next steps the team proposes taking regarding the implementation of the approved edits and as you can see all of the smiling faces of the committee members for the governor's commission on african-american history education in the commonwealth so the commission's

[01:28:36] work um as was stated in our previous presentation um began october 28 2019 at the university of virginia and i'm not going to read all of this to you because most of it was presented in the presentation before but the committee members were divided into two self-selected subcommittees one that dealt with standards and the other that dealt with professional development the standard subcommittee work group again led by Dr. Cassandra Nubie-Alexander were tasked with these three main

[01:29:14] points and again this is something that you heard in the previous presentation so i won't go through all of those with you but that same standard subcommittee did self-select into three work groups one work group took care of looking at the process another looked at the standards reorganization or standards overhaul as it was noted in the previous presentation and then the third work group looked at technical edits on this slide you will see that this is the definition or

[01:29:51] basically the charge that we gave the work group technical edit work group when looking at the curriculum frameworks and we wanted to emphasize that edits or changes to the standard would need to go through an approval process by the board of education because the board approves the standards that technical edits work group was led by dr edward ayers of the university of virginia and i would also like to point out that in this presentation even though it's not colored

[01:30:25] differently the curriculum frameworks from 2015 that the technical edits work group focused on were the frameworks from Virginia Studies, United States History to 1865, United States History 1865 to the present, and the Virginia and United States History course. Virginia Studies is generally taught in elementary school, United States History 1865 and then 1865 to the present, those are generally taught at middle school, and Virginia and United States History is generally

[01:31:03] taught in upper high school so the technical edits work group met during commission meetings between december 2019 and february 2020. they did a lot of work offline to review and discuss the edits in preparation for an april commission meeting and then they presented their recommendations to the Standards Subcommittee in June of 2020. The Standards Subcommittee and members from the VDOE,

[01:31:42] of course due to COVID, we met virtually with the Standards Subcommittee July 6th, 14th, 15th, and 16th, and they were gracious enough to take time out of their days, their evenings, to work on these documents, knowing how important it was to present, again, as Dr. Nubi Alexander said, a more inclusive history. So the Standards Subcommittee reviewed and approved the recommendations for the Commission's final report, and that final report was presented to the Governor August 1,

[01:32:21] 2020. Earlier this month, the Departments of Learning and Innovation, Policy, Equity, and communications and student assessment reviewed the recommendations from the commission to compile a document that outlines the recommendations for the edits the superintendent and senior leadership reviewed the document um and those are the attachments that you have in

[01:32:56] attachment a and attachment b the charts basically outline the original language from the 2015 curriculum frameworks the edits as recommended by the commission the type of edit in a suggestion in some cases from the vdoe and then the recommended action so spending a little time here the recommendations outlined in the attachments organized those recommendations into two categories

[01:33:31] for board consideration category one from board decisions are edits to the curriculum framework category two for your consideration may be considered for the review and the revision process in 2022 they also outline substantive changes to the content or additions to the standards but i do want to reiterate that department staff based on guidance may make additional changes that will incorporate recommendations that are currently in category

[01:34:08] two and moving them into category one so what i'd like to share with you is an example of a edit that would fall into category one what you see on your screen is the curriculum framework page from united states history to 1865. this particular standard deals with key individuals or the roles

[01:34:43] taken during the american revolution as you can see there are key individuals listed in the standard the standard itself reads and you can see that there is with emphasis on george washington benjamin franklin thomas jefferson patrick henry and the marquis de lafayette the edit recommended

[01:35:18] by the commission was to add key individuals christmas addicts and james armistead lafayette the curriculum framework content the essential knowledge does list other individuals such as king george iii thomas paine lord cornwallis and john adams so in fitting with the definition or the direction that we gave to the standard subcommittee the addition of crispus addicts and

[01:35:53] James Armistead Lafayette fits in Category 1. Slot 11 is an example of a recommendation for Category 2 where the addition does affect the standard or it may be considered content or the recommendation may be considered during the review process as an individual standard or a substandard for deeper exploration of the content or the additional concepts introduced in

[01:36:28] the edit. This particular standard is from high school, Virginia and U.S. history. The recommended edit is a substantive change and there are concepts that we may want to think about either

during the review and revision process or developing a standard or a substandard that would gives teachers and students an opportunity to deeper have a deeper exploration of the concepts

[01:37:08] or the content that's being introduced so recognizing that the standards are approved by the board it was necessary to place these recommendations into one of two categories again i would like to reiterate that based on further direction the department staff may make additional changes that will incorporate the recommendations presented in category two to move

[01:37:42] them to category one and incorporate them in the present curriculum frameworks so what are our next steps with all of these different recommendations and incorporation into the curriculum frameworks we heard earlier from the commission's presentation that there is a need for professional development and the development of resources so our next steps would be to present to you next month for curriculum frameworks a strikethrough copy so that you can see the actual

[01:38:21] frameworks and what is being either eliminated or changed or added we also would like to communicate these edits to school divisions through a superintendent's memo and then of course using other communication mechanisms such as teacher direct our newsletter that is communicated to our history and social science contacts and leaders and then also to the public since the inception of the commission we have had so many different museums cultural organizations

[01:38:59] universities historians reach out to us to find out how they can help and best support the edits or the recommendations to our curriculum frameworks.

[01:39:14] Those recommendations that we do have in Category 1, anticipating that they would be approved, our program has already started working on resources to reflect those edits.

[01:39:32] Throughout this year, again, providing a variety of professional development because as was stated in presentation earlier we have many teachers and students and communities that are unfamiliar with this history slides 13 through 15 this is the selected bibliography that the work groups and the standard subcommittee used for their um utilized for their technical edits and as you can

[01:40:12] see, it is a very exhaustive list. I don't believe, and Dr. Nubi-Alexander may want to chime in a little bit later, this is probably not everything that they use to develop the recommendation. So I thank you very much for your time. At this time, the team and I would

[01:40:46] be happy to take any questions regarding any of the information that has been presented, But before that, I guess, I should say the superintendent recommends that the Board of Education receive for first review the recommendations from the standard subcommittee from the Governor's Commission on African American History.

[01:41:09] So thank you, Mr. Gecker, and I'll take questions. The team and I will take questions at this time. Thank you for the full and complete presentation, and frankly, thank you for the joyous manner which you presented it it's a pleasure to listen to honestly thank you mr gecker okay uh any questions uh dr lane first i guess i see him i just wanted to provide wrap-up comments and just say uh again a thank you to for signing the team at the doe and especially the commission i i just wanted to reiterate that just becomes because something was placed in category one versus

[01:41:49] category two doesn't mean it's a better change or a lesser change it was just really a matter of form and process that that we were trying to assess obviously we're really appreciative of all of the

recommendations and hope to to support them all the other thing i would say is uh the governor received this in in uh early august we had a basically about a month before we started putting together the board packet and as we even yesterday are reviewing these we're finding things where we say, well, when they put it here, it's substantive, but maybe there are other places that we could put some of their edits that actually don't change the meaning of the standard.

[01:42:26] And between now and October, we'll continue to refine the product for you. And so I just wanted to add that piece. But thank you again, Mr. Gecker, for giving me a moment just to wrap up. And Kristanya, amazing work. Thank you. Any other comments by board members? President Gecker, actually, Dr. Lane and Ms. Brown, thank you so much for all the hard work.

[01:42:48] i think uh the comment you just made may have clarified for me so the department actually created the two buckets or did the technical edits just come as one and they got grouped this way and then in order to sort of contend with where uh changes were going to best be dealt with either through a technical edit or as content for a revision process because it's substantively changes the standard i just i really wanted to just kind of have that understanding clear in my in my head as i look at this the the two categories that have been created uh were developed by the

[01:43:28] department um and frankly um even in category one uh there's probably a broader definition of technical edit being applied than the board has historically thought about when you offer the department the right to just make the changes to technical edits usually a technical edit is uh uh you know factual inaccuracies and or grammatical corrections but because of the the number of changes you know frankly and that that's part of our review over the last month we're we're talking

[01:44:02] about dozens of pages that that we've been uh working through each one uh because of the number of them and the substance of them and because of the precedent that the board has set historically even though it's not in the regs or the code that you adopt frameworks, we felt like all of this work should be adopted by the board. And so we categorize this for you now in two categories, but again, we're continuing to refine our thoughts that maybe exactly where the commission put it made it a substantive change, but if we could, you know, a great example of this might be where

[01:44:38] there are, there's a standard on discrimination, but the edit that they made wasn't in that area, but it clearly addresses and clarifies the factual accuracies around discrimination. If we could put it there, it might be falling more into this shorter-term edit type of process, and so we'll continue to refine that over the next month. But the categories, as they're outlined today, were done by the instruction team. Thank you, very helpful.

[01:45:09] You're on. Thank you again, Ms. Brown, for your presentation, and I look forward to enthusiastically, as you presented, supporting us next time. One quick question and can you just provide a little bit more clarity on the professional development? You indicated a variety of professional development will be happening.

[01:45:30] What are some examples and then what is going to be an accountability measure for for us and for VDOE to know that that has happened? I think again that's going to be paramount to how this will be able to be implemented and actually happening in classrooms.

[01:45:45] And so I just wanted to hear a little bit more about what that looks like and also if you can comment on any partnerships or conversations you're having with our teacher preparation programs and

how we can change some of what happens there as well. Thank you for that.

[01:46:00] Well, I'll take the first part and maybe someone else on the team would like to talk about the accountability piece. And I'm very happy that our co-chairs and Dr. Atkins and Dr. Nubia Alexander are still on the line because we had many members of the commission, historians, professors, volunteer to do work with us to provide professional development.

[01:46:29] As a matter of fact, I believe it's next month, Dr. Duby-Alexander, correct me if I'm wrong, she's going to be working specifically with the teachers who are involved with teaching the new African-American history course in doing a short video with them where she will be sharing, basically teaching content relative to the landing of the first Africans in British North America.

[01:46:59] That particular session will be recorded and that will be available for all of our teachers to be able to view, but it's going to be specifically for the teachers who are teaching in the new african-american history course for that course we have four professors already lined up to teach content because again much of this content may be new to some of our history and social science teachers all of those sessions with those teachers

[01:47:34] will be recorded as we are in a virtual situation like we are right now we have the opportunity to videotape those sessions for content purposes. Also, we have started this year, the history and social science program, a professional development series, which is called building a community of learners. And during the month of August, we lined up with four different museums to present content

[01:48:09] and the use of resources and the development of resources. As a matter of fact, tonight we have a series with the Library of Congress. Last month, we had a session that was also taped with the Virginia Museum of History and Culture.

[01:48:29] We have also lined up sessions with the Civil War Museum. And we also have a session, I believe, I can't give you the exact date, with the moton museum many of the topics that were recommended as edits to the curriculum framework we have either been in contact as they have reached out to us or we have reached out to them for content on building background knowledge for our teachers now the second phase of that with building a community of learners many of the teachers that are involved in those sessions

[01:49:09] we have asked to create resources based on what they learned so that we can then take those resources and post them on the website when these recommendations are put in place in our curriculum frameworks so there won't be a lag time between the document being posted of new content and resources to help teach that new content as far as working with accountability for that dr lane if you wouldn't mind i'll just talk to you yes thank you uh and uh there are a lot of

[01:49:49] opportunities here uh dr duran for the board to influence accountability you may remember nearly a year ago we created our what we were referencing as the 18-month plan to change the teacher evaluation system in the commonwealth and uh we're tracking along on that i don't i don't know that we'll hit 18 months exactly with covid to be honest but uh um we completed phase one with the board as you know which was to change the requirement uh that uh the test scores were a 40 focus the evaluation and and built a you know a broader focus across all of the seven standards

[01:50:27] that the board had. In phase two, you may remember that we were going to make further edits to the teacher evaluation system to essentially improve the system that we have. And then once that's

completed, we would enter phase three, where we really look at procuring and developing an entirely new system. As part of that review, you may remember that we talked about the potential for adding additional standards, such as a standard on diversity, equity, culturally relevant teaching, so on and so forth. And I think that that would be an opportunity where, you know,

[01:51:04] I don't know that it's the VDOE holding school divisions or schools accountable for it, but it's certainly our school leaders holding staff accountable for ensuring that they develop their skills in this area. As part of that presentation, we also talked about ways the board could think differently about teacher professional development requirements. Instead of it being 180 hours we would we would categorize those hours in major buckets in alignment with the teacher evaluation system so if you created this diversity culturally relevant teaching cultural competence thread in the in the evaluation then there would be certain mandates that we could put

[01:51:44] on staff that they required training in all of those areas now as it relates to assessment accountability that is another major component that the board uses to make sure that the content is taught and in the uh as intended and keep in mind that the assessments are written in alignment with the standards the framework are frameworks are there to help build on the standards and so the new assessments would be developed following the 2022 revision which actually we call it 2022 but that process starts in january and so uh in building the new standards uh we will immediately

[01:52:23] upon completion that begin building new assessments and then that is the student accountability for the the content as well thank you dr lane and miss brown that was very helpful and i think as we move forward dr lane i'm glad you reminded us and brought back into the conversation what we need to be considering as we think about professional development and i agree i don't think it's about video we holding people exclusives accountable but how do we make sure our staff and our school districts are supported in a way to get the consistency of the professional development that we want and need to see across the commonwealth so i appreciate that and look

[01:53:01] forward to further conversations on that and and again as a side i just hope we'll also be continuing these conversations with our four-year universities our teacher prep programs to how we help prepare teachers coming in i think that's a whole other avenue of a way we can help prepare our staff better thank you mr gecker may i comment yes of course thank you um dr duran also in one of the recommendations was around licensure be that the initial license or the renewal of the license that a part of that professional development would include african-american history

[01:53:40] uh cultural competencies would be embedded in the coursework that's required for the license or the renewal of the license very similar to the department of education um i guess two or three years ago required that teachers and those who hold a Virginia license actually take a course in in literacy for special education students and that was very helpful to be able to push that out to all of our staff including leadership so we would be heading along that same pathway and

[01:54:19] that's our recommendation excellent thank you dr atkins thank you and dr wilson thank you President Gecker. Dr. Atkins, I appreciate you mentioning the importance of building and division leadership as part of that professional development plan and incorporating them. So thank you for that.

[01:54:38] And then just very generally, Christiana, I appreciate to the department and the commission as well this commitment to process and thinking through step by step how we ensure a process Karen Hollweg, For moving forward with the recommendations that have been made. So I just wanted to

acknowledge your commitment to that our commitment as a board to that and giving us the opportunity to think through next steps and how appropriately we move forward. So thank you.

[01:55:10] Lisa Smith, Thank you. All right. Lisa Smith, Mr. Lisa Smith, it's open. Lisa Smith, Thank you. I'd like to chime in and join others and thanking this brown for her and her team's hard work and in particular, how quickly you worked to respond to the Commission's recommendations. I do note that we have heard a lot of public comment. I think President Gecker mentioned this at the opening of the meeting. There have been a handful of dissenting voices, but I note that the vast majority of the public we've heard from, including

[01:55:47] noted history scholars in the K-12 space and in higher ed and the cultural museums from Colonial Williamsburg on across the Commonwealth have all been very, very supportive of the agenda items that we're presented with today. I do have one question for Ms. Brown and that is, and maybe this is for Dr. Lane as well, but as you wrestle with this two-bucket approach, I trust that you are continuing to confer with the co-chairs of the commission.

[01:56:22] Yes, ma'am. If as you come back, if they have views that are different from the departments in terms of how quickly we should be able to move on these items, which should be in bucket one versus bucket two, for instance, I'd appreciate it if you can alert us to that.

[01:56:41] you know, we want their continuing feedback and we want to act as quickly as we can on their recommendations, but obviously also honoring our ongoing standard processes. So if there are things that we can't do as the commission leadership would think that we should be doing, I would like to hear about that and have us deliberate together about what are our options we can look that so that's somewhat a question and somewhat a comment and miss holton i will say uh absolutely

[01:57:14] we we finalized our documents uh as you can see in your agenda yesterday and uh and i i can assure you that i called dr atkins last night to let her know our approach and we're we're working to schedule a meeting with all three of the co-chairs to review this in the in the coming week where we can uh make sure that we can get on the same page and and really discuss a couple of those items i mentioned that maybe in the substantive category now but maybe if we shift it around could find some evidence to make it technical and certainly we'll make sure we work hand-in-hand with Commission and we'll commit to that thank you

[01:57:51] okay anybody else if not I'd like to thank everybody again for their participation on this item and you know we accepted for first review and we will look forward to dealing with it next month the sooner you can get the list out the revised list the better you know dr lane and i had a call i guess monday james to go over what was then the list we spent a couple hours going through item by item and so the sooner you can do it the better for in terms of preparation for the next meeting and where we go from there

[01:58:30] so thank you all very much we've been doing this now for you know almost two hours it may be an appropriate time for a break you know if there's a lot of you know resistance from the board on that issue i guess i'd reconsider but i see some support so finally i'm going to get something through the board and i guess we will go to break and be back at noon sharp if

[01:58:54] that's okay thank you thank you let me see that baby oh the puppy's here he's here oh i thought

[02:08:11] i'd let him make an appearance look at that sweet face he's a little wet from the rain outside hold him up a little bit more emily oh he's so cute this is kobe hi kobe how big will he be ultimately uh the vet estimates about 25 pounds uh when we went to for his first appointment

[02:08:46] on tuesday he's four and a half so he's a little little bitty thing he's a lot of fluff uh right now we've been working on trying to brush his hair with with golden doodles you gotta keep keep their hair brushed so they don't get matte so we're trying to get him used to that yep nothing better than a dog in a home well 3 a.m i might disagree but generally speaking he's doing very well

[02:09:27] Those are my favorite dogs, Emily, Golden Doodles. I just love them. Yeah. I don't have one right now because of time, but I babysit three different Golden Doodles all the time. My friends who have them. I mean, I haven't even had him a week yet, and I feel like he's already made such progress.

[02:09:49] They're very smart dogs. I mean, amazing. Yes. We are starting training next week because we're going to get socialized and be a good puppy. Where are you doing your training, Emily? Right now, we're going to do Petco. They don't have any group puppy classes because of COVID, so it's going to have to be private, which, you know, not thrilled about, but we got to get him well-behaved.

[02:10:28] Okay, is everybody back? I can't tell. I think so. Our next... Okay, Dr. Duran, you're on, right?

[02:10:43] Our next item is... I'm here, yeah. Okay, thank you. Ann, I think it's here. I see Dr. Pexton. Yeah, we're all here. Okay. Then we will get started again. I guess item G, first review of an amendment to Virginia's consolidated state plan under ESSA. And that would be Ms. Follick and Dr. Sodat. Good afternoon, I guess.

[02:11:14] Oh, good afternoon, now. Yeah. Good afternoon, officially. President Gecker, members of the board, and Dr. Zane. Dr. Sodat and I are here to present to you for first review a proposed amendment to the Virginia Consolidated State Plan under the Every Student Succeeds Act.

[02:11:32] As you're aware, Virginia's Consolidated State Plan addresses a variety of federal compliance topics. The intention of the plan is to be a living document where adjustments through amendments may be necessary as we complete our work. Today we are presenting to you for first review an amendment to the plan that will address three changes to the plan.

[02:11:52] The first change involves the exemption that ESSA provides surrounding students in 8th grade who are enrolled in Algebra 1. These students are allowed to take the Algebra 1 mathematics assessment instead of the grade level assessment since Algebra 1 is a higher level assessment.

[02:12:08] Virginia has received a waiver to extend this exemption to all students starting at grade 3 who are enrolled in advanced courses allowing them to take the advanced mathematics assessment in lieu of the grade level assessment. However, if a student takes advantage of this exception, the student is required to take a higher-level mathematics test in high school to meet the federal mathematics assessment requirements.

[02:12:32] To be clear, the proposed amendment does not seek to change this exception. The current plan states that students must pass the Alger 1 SOL test in grade 8 to then use a higher-level mathematics assessment in high school for federal requirements.

[02:12:49] This amendment would change that language to indicate the student must simply take, not necessarily pass, the Algebra I SOL test in grade 8 to then use a higher-level mathematics assessment in

high school. This technical change will clarify expectations for students who may have passed the Algebra I course in grade 8 but took and did not pass the Algebra I SOL assessment.

[02:13:11] It also allows consistency and expectations for students who also take the Geometry or algebra 2 sol tests in middle school as detailed in virginia's advanced mathematics waiver the other two items for your review within the proposed amendment will be provided by dr lynn soda dr dr soda thank you thank you julie uh good afternoon uh mr gecker uh members of the board and dr lane the next two items really are um i would call them mostly housekeeping items but but they are

[02:13:46] changes that we have contacted uscd about and have been informed that they need to be submitted via the amendment process the sec the second item on your agenda is an update through the title one part c which is our migrant education program measurable objectives and we do have six regional meps across virginia this is a relatively small program a relatively small grant and that carries with it actually quite a few rather explicit requirements and one of those requirements

[02:14:20] is that every third year we work with our migrant education programs to complete a comprehensive needs assessment, make updates to our service delivery plan, and make updates to our measurable objectives as deemed necessary by the group. The measurable objectives are somewhat prescribed by the U.S. Department of Education and that they must include certain elements and address certain things. And we worked with our MEPs throughout the course of the 2019-2020 school year to complete

[02:14:55] these requirements and we do have some updated updates to our measurable objective. We contacted the U.S. Department of Education and asked if an amendment was required to update the objectives in the plan and we were informed that we could either update the objectives in the plan and then every time we change the objectives submit a new amendment or we could submit an amendment that referred usd to our videoe website for the most current measurable objectives so we are proposing

[02:15:31] that approach for title one part c and then the third item for your consideration is in addition to the language that we provided in our ESSA state plan on state uses of funds under Title IV, Part A, student support and academic enrichment programs. And this program is really a relatively broad program with relatively few requirements as compared to the migrant program. Funds are used to support well-rounded education, sort of safe and healthy students in schools, and the

[02:16:08] effective use of technology our current state plan describes our use of our state set-aside funds to support our school divisions with technology integration and digital literacy during the 1920 school year the need to support our school divisions in addressing technology readiness infrastructure access connectivity as you can imagine data security and their e-rate participation emerged we did contact uscd to see if our plan was written broadly enough to

[02:16:44] incorporate those uses of state activities funds to support our school divisions and we were told no that we needed to submit an amendment to add that language so that we could support our school divisions with those initiatives it's certainly an allowable use of funds it just needs to be included in our state so that is the last one i believe julie uh for this amendment all right thank you then um so we anticipate the board will take action on the amendment at the october board

[02:17:18] meeting um the superintendent of public instruction recommends the board of education receive from first of you the amendment to the consolidated state plan mr gecker we'd happy to we would

be happy to respond any questions are there any questions i don't see any questions so uh thank you for the presentation and the board is happy to accept it on first review and we'll see you in

[02:17:47] october thank you thank you okay uh item h first review of a process to certify a list of qualified persons for the office of division superintendents of schools good afternoon president gecker members can you hear me yes thank you good president gecker members of the board and dr lane at the request of the board i am pleased to present to you a process to certify a list of qualified

[02:18:22] persons for the office of division superintendent of schools the constitution of virginia requires the board of education to certify to use the school board of each division a list of qualified persons for the office of division superintendent of schools one of whom shall be selected to fill the post by the division school board i will begin by giving you some historical context prior to 1993 the virginia board of education did not issue a division superintendent license

[02:18:58] rather the names of individuals who met the qualifications to serve as a division superintendent are placed on a list of eligible superintendents. Individuals would submit an application which would include transcripts, experiences, letters of recommendations, and if individuals met the requirements their names were presented to the Board of Education each month and the Board of Education would certify those names for the list. Periodically a status report would be sent to

[02:19:34] those individuals whose names were on the list to inquire if they wanted to continue their name on the list and to update information and to receive a status on any professional development or experiences in which that individual had completed. There became more of an issue for individuals when they would go to another state, they didn't have a license, there was this eligible list which other states were very unfamiliar with and the individual had no credential to

[02:20:13] give to that other state or even to school boards to show that they had met the requirement there was just the list so in 1993 the board of education established a division superintendent license. Once that license was established, no longer did staff bring to the Board of Education a list of individuals who met requirements for the list of eligible superintendents.

[02:20:45] That list continued to be maintained and is to this day. When someone requests that list, we can generate it from those individuals who hold an active division superintendent license.

[02:21:01] Currently the Board of Education has four options from which an individual may be eligible for a division superintendent license. I'm just gonna very quickly go over those with you. The first three options all require teaching experience as well as experience in administration supervision.

[02:21:22] Option one requires that an individual must have a doctorate in educational leadership. Option two requires the individual to have a master's degree, be eligible for the administration and supervision endorsement, as well as have 30 graduate hours beyond the date the master's degree was conferred. Option three is requires that an out-of-state division superintendent license be held. The fourth option, which is the one that is used

[02:21:59] most infrequently, is when a school board has selected a candidate who does not meet options one through three, but has a master's degree, has a minimum of three years of successful experience in a senior leadership position, such as A CEO or a military officer and we receive a recommendation from the school board that this individual is the candidate of choice for the superintendency.

[02:22:34] Now, those are the options. Many times, school boards will contact me and they want to announce a superintendent pretty quickly. Someone who may be coming from out of state or who may be applying through option four, and they want us to expedite the request, which we have honored. So it's not unusual for us to turn these around

[02:23:01] very, very quickly within three or four days. And that will change with the proposed process. And the proposed Board of Education procedure to certify the list of qualified persons for the office of division superintendent is as follows.

[02:23:19] Initially, we will bring to the board a list of everyone who has an active division superintendent license to ask the board to certify those individuals. Subsequently, when new applications are received by the department, we will review them to ensure that they've met the requirements in options one through four.

[02:23:41] And we will bring those names to the board of education to certify. Once the certification by the board, our office in teacher education and licensure will issue the division superintendent license. The timeline for the certification and the issuance of the division superintendent licenses will certainly depend on the receipt of the completed application packet and the board of education meeting dates.

[02:24:10] So there will need to be some notice to school boards that they will need to prepare in advance, because that's not always happened in the past.

[02:24:25] But the superintendent's recommendation is that the Board of Education receive for first review the process to certify a list of qualified persons for the Office of Division Superintendent of Schools. Thank you. - Thank you, are there any questions?

[02:24:43] - I have a question. - All right, Dr. Wilson. - Patty, thanks very much for the history on the whole process and the recommendation. So just to clarify, with this new process, it will not be until the board certifies an individual that the division superintendent license will be released.

[02:25:05] Is that correct or am I not hearing that right? - Yes, ma'am, you are accurate. The board would have to certify the name and then we would immediately after the board met and certified the names, issued the division superintendent license.

[02:25:25] - Dr. Dharani. - Ms. Pitts, can you explain then if the board is doing that and there's a quest for a hire or someone that needs a certification in the interim and we may not be meeting as we don't meet every month that we meet once a month, what will happen then?

[02:25:41] Are those individuals, for example, when we don't meet in February or in August and there's a span from July to September, how would we support those school districts or those candidates? That would be the major change in this process.

[02:26:00] There would be a delay. So individuals will need to apply early. I will tell you that many times I receive calls from individuals who are applying for a superintendency in Virginia. And they indicate to me that they're just going to wait to apply until they get an interview.

[02:26:23] People are going to need to apply earlier to be placed on the eligible list and receive their license. So to follow up, there could be individuals that would have to wait two months to get their license then if we are not in session.

[02:26:43] And that would be, then that individual actually could not start in their position as superintendent without that license or be hired. Is that correct? So we could have some divisions having to wait, potentially, up to two months before they could hire someone or someone start.

[02:26:58] Is that accurate to say? - Yes, that is accurate. Before the appointment could be made, they would have to be on the eligible list of division superintendents, yes. - Well, I'm concerned about that. And Dr. Lane, I don't know if you'd like to comment on that or if you've thought about that, or if you've had conversations with anyone about that, but that's concerning to me.

[02:27:22] And I think to Ms. Pitt's point, once people get the information and know they have to do it ahead of time, that could take some time to do that. But I worry that some individuals in school divisions might be burdened by not being able to hire, have someone start for a month and a half or two if we're not in session. I don't know if there's anything, Dr. Lane, you thought on that or how you might respond, but that does trouble me a little bit and concern me. No, we have thought about that at length and discussed it with the board president and others. Ultimately, this is a constitutional requirement and the board does have to certify the list as it's written in the

[02:28:01] constitution. And, you know, one of the things that we debated is, could you designate that certification of the list to the department? And we just don't believe that you can constitutionally. And so it does make it more difficult, but, you know, candidates should know the qualifications and begin the process early. And we can turn this around pretty quickly. And most school board processes take much longer than two months. Most of them take several months. And if the applicants start the process with us at the time of application we probably can get to a timing that

[02:28:41] you know even when they start negotiating contract there's a couple more weeks that you know we can we can get to uh so they can make the appointment this is obviously not ideal uh from a timing standpoint and would uh seek the expertise of the legal minds on the board if you think there's a another solution um but in the context of uh of this constitutional requirement this is the this is the best avenue that we could think of we could obviously issue the license and then they can still not be appointed until you certify but you know patty uses this metaphor that's like

[02:29:17] giving somebody a driver's license and telling them they can't drive until the dmv meet we'd rather not have them holding a license until it's fully effective thank you two follow-ups um one i hope that once this goes into effect we would have good conversation with all the superintendent search firms because there's some major you know there's not a lot of them but there's probably four or five predominantly that are used so that they're aware of this so that they can make that part of their application to dr main's point it doesn't just happen overnight but when they apply to their search firm process that they would know to do this that's that would

[02:29:54] be my my big um push on that if we could do that and then um president gecker or emily i don't know if this is something that we could do is there a way that we could vote on something in our a month off whenever we do some type of vote will we come together i don't know i know some other boards i've been on uh we of course they're non-profit boards so it's a little different but we do votes on things appointing folks when we're not meeting in between them it's a personnel matter um to to not hold things up so i don't know i guess that was dr lane's question about the legal component know if that's even possible but I do think that the critical aspect will be from the get-go all

[02:30:34] applicants knowing that this has changed and the search firms would be the best individuals to be guiding that process. I think we also need to engage in a conversation with the school boards association as well so that they can inform all of their membership if this requirement is changed because they they are the ones making these decisions but you are completely right it will change the the timeline and people will need to apply earlier it's not something that our office

[02:31:09] will hold up but the meeting time of the board could impact some decisions mr president yes i just i've been working with patty on this issue and i just to get to the uh question um that was it was just asked about voting on something without a meeting of the board, FOIA prohibits that.

[02:31:33] So there would not be a way for the board to vote on the list of eligibles unless they were in a public meeting. - I guess the question is, could we have a public meeting for that purpose? But, and the answer to that I think is yes, even in our office if called by the president, I think is the way that works or-- - Yes, that's accurate, yeah.

[02:31:56] - So, Mr. President. - Yes, ma'am. I appreciate Francisco raising this issue, and we'd hate to hamper divisions flexibility unnecessarily if there's a way around it. The one that me most is option four, which as Patty notes, is the least frequent option.

[02:32:16] But if somebody is hiring somebody outside of the normal licensure process, hiring a CEO from business say, right now they have to be recommended by a school board interested in employing the individual.

[02:32:31] So in other words, the school board would have to vote decide they wanted to employ them and then we would have to put them on the list. I'm wondering if that language could be I don't know amended or clarified to say amended by a school board considering employing the individual so that person you know a CEO from a different sector could be licensed during the application process rather than could be applying to be put on the the eligibility list during the application process rather than once it was fully completed

[02:33:10] so i don't know whether there's some language to look at there that's one thought and then the other that would worry me is we have to vote on it in open sessions or is there a way to be you know most everything we do about individual licenses is confidential or at least much of it is but so somebody may be applying for a position in in virginia but not want to be on a public meeting agenda being approved for a Virginia eligibility list because

[02:33:44] he or she is a working superintendent say in Texas and may not want their Texas division to know they're in an application process here until it's close to concluding. So I'm a little worried about it. I mean maybe Dan's latest suggestion is you know if I mean often decisions are being made many months before the employment's going to start so if you're announcing a choice in February to start in June the the school board could announce that they're hiring somebody subject to the

[02:34:18] appropriate licensing and still the process could go forward by the time they start in June but on rare occasions when you don't have that kind of a window maybe this board could agree to schedule emergency meetings i mean you know hopefully it wouldn't come up too often so the new response to your first suggestion about considering allowing individuals to apply themselves for option four is um that you know that was a requirement um that's been in place for many many years there

[02:34:52] are only about 10 individuals who have received who have active licenses now who received the division superintendent license under option four the concern is that that option is an alternate route and it's based upon a school board that has already interviewed the person and feels that that individual who may not have educational background and experience is the best for that particular

[02:35:23] position so i would caution a little bit about making that a requirement that anyone could apply who had a master's degree who had a leadership position without having some kind of vetting by school board that really wanted to hire the person so and i just to clarify i wasn't suggesting that we drop the requirement of school board information but that maybe the school board instead of saying we want to hire them would say we are have determined to interview them or we've determined

[02:36:03] that we're we're interested in them so in other words lessening that the requirement from the school board be not this is our candidate but this is one of our candidates or so and i don't know how you would get the language right on that but again if patty am i right that our our public meetings would be um it would be public that um whether through this option four or through any of the routes that a candidate is uh it would be public that candidate xyz is asking to be placed

[02:36:42] on the eligibles list right we would bring a list to you each month reinstating what we did prior to 1993 and this would be after the individual's credentials application have been reviewed then we would bring those forth to the board of education to certify and what we will need to do even for option four is to inform and educate school board members of the change because many

[02:37:19] times they are collecting the credentials the day before they're they're trying to appoint so in many times i have to say well you the person has to have a division superintendent license you must submit the credentials they overnight them to me so it will just be a shift for individuals that they will need to give this priority and really should make um and include in their notice when they're advertising that individuals need to begin collecting their

[02:37:51] application and paperwork to be prepared if they are appointed so i president gacker yes dr mann i just wanted to understand so there because of the code virginia code there's no provision to allow this kind of thing to be done in an executive session by the board i'm i mean i'm just i just

[02:38:22] that's like prohibited because executive sessions are only as we deal with other issues of personnel and executive session i'm more for it i'm just curious about that uh there is no freedom of information act exception that would cover our meeting our constitutional obligation to certify a list of superintendents and since susan's on the phone please feel free to correct any misstatements i make since you're i guess our lawyer that was you are absolutely accurate in

[02:38:58] that there is not a foia exemption that would protect that and i'm betting that years ago when the list back before 1993 uh was approved i'm sure it was approved in in a public meeting and it also has to be communicated to the school divisions which makes it a document that is of course subject to foia disclosure under foia okay anybody else on this topic you know i appreciate

[02:39:32] the concerns but uh you know at the end of the day i don't see uh how we avoid the express constitutional language in this case so i would just ask that we ask the department to reach out to the school board association and the superintendent's association and see if they have any suggested possible tweaks that could help and otherwise to communicate to them our willingness to entertain to consider emergency meetings if something comes up i mean obviously

[02:40:08] we can't guarantee anything i will say this you know the legislative history on this seems to be that one of the original drafts of the constitution would have allowed the board to actually appoint the division superintendents and the compromise apparently was to allow the board just to certify the list from which a superintendent could be had if that all makes sense so i mean there is some legislative history well some from uh dick howard's book on the constitutional uh on the

[02:40:43] revision of the constitution 71 that's sort of what it suggests is that there were two approaches one to give the state complete power and one to you know give the state some power that is picking the list and that's the one that made it to the constitution so fascinating It is, yeah. All right. Any other comments on this? And if none, thank you, Ms. Pitts. And we will proceed forward. We've accepted that for first review.

[02:41:15] Thank you. Thank you. Item I, first review of proposed revisions to the regulations governing educational services for gifted students. Mr. Bowling. Good afternoon, President Gecker, Dr. Lane, members of the board. It's my pleasure to present to you the proposed changes for the regulations governing the education of the gifted.

[02:41:37] For first review, the last comprehensive review of these regulations occurred in 2010 in 2018 the Board of Education charged the VA CEG with reviewing policies and programming practices that supported equitable access to gifted programs for underserved populations of students.

[02:42:00] In June 2019, their report was presented to the board, along with the notice of intended regulatory action to open the review of the regulations. over the past year, approximately 30 members of the VACEG contributed to the process of reviewing and revising the regulations.

[02:42:21] These members included parents, superintendents, gifted education coordinators, teachers, and college faculty. During the 2020 General Assembly session, House Bill 1139, Delegate Keem, passed and required the board to review the regulations and make changes for more equitable screening and identification of gifted students.

[02:42:46] The proposed changes align with the requirements of HB 1139. Those changes do include, first, additions to and revisions of definitions for critical terms.

[02:43:04] Number two, realignment of aspects of the screening, referral, identification, and placement components of the regulations to support best practices aligning with equitable access for gifted students, especially students from underrepresented populations.

[02:43:20] Third, revisions of components of the local plan for the education of the gifted. Fourth, revision of the role and function of the local advisory committee for the education of the gifted.

[02:43:37] And finally, addition of an annual report expectations. The proposed revisions to the regulations will allow the board to update and guide school division identification procedures and services for gifted education. Eventual additions and revisions to the annual report will serve to highlight and communicate a division's progress towards equitable representation and services in their gifted program. At this time I'm happy to answer any questions that you might have and I may I'd like to take a second to thank Dr. Donna

[02:44:16] Poland who's off also on this call for her work with the VA CEG to bring all of these proposed regulations to the board. Are there any questions? Thank you Mr. Bolling and Dr. Poland. Dr. Wilson, yes.

Thank you President Gecker and Mr. Bolling thanks for your tee up here to this item and Donna good to see you. A question about the folks involved in crafting the revisions of proposed

[02:44:54] revisions. I know you rattled off a list of kind of the constituency groups who were represented. It would be helpful perhaps in next month's presentation for us to have a list of you know who those folks are and the communities that they represent because as we're talking about representing equity across, we want to make sure that the public is quite aware of how that information was gathered as the report or the recommendations were put together. That would be

[02:45:23] helpful. We'd be happy to do that. Okay, anybody else? Mr. President? Yes, ma'am. Ms. Halton. Thank you.

[02:45:41] Mr. Bowling, thank you. I must confess I didn't read this as closely as I could have initially, so I'm skimming through the recommendations. Am I correct in understanding that the gifted programs are already required to submit a regular plan on a regular basis?

[02:46:04] does that plan now or would these uh amendments require that that plan include setting goals and a process for achieving goals of equitable access to gifted education dr poland i'm going to give this one to you there are some components that do require that um and

[02:46:35] And it might be that I think the committee looked at more at making changes to require divisions to address the annual report, which actually will be changed to look at more trend lines and issues surrounding the actual divisions representation across all populations.

[02:47:09] Right now that report is extremely lacking in providing that information to divisions in any kind of format that's usable or understandable. And so that report is where the committee felt like it was key to make sure that report was a focus within the regulations and that the report itself, which would hopefully be changed over the next year would also address those issues to kind of force a

[02:47:43] conversation within the divisions there are goals within the plan that address different aspects and it doesn't I don't think it specifically calls out that they have to have a plan of action to address underrepresented groups but we We could certainly add that.

[02:48:10] - Well, I will read more carefully before our next review would be interested in that topic. I'm conscious of the conversations going on around the governor's schools right now, and I know that's a different question from this directly, but I'm also aware of the literature on gifted programs across the country tending to not reflect students from underrepresented backgrounds the way they should and missed opportunities there and how some of the testing and methods for identifying students for those programs

[02:48:48] are skewed in a variety of ways. You know, I know, as I say, I know this isn't directly related to the governor's schools, but all three of my children attended governor's schools in Virginia. Two attended Maggie Walker and one attended Art, the Appomattox Governor's School.

[02:49:05] one of those is diverse. The Appomattox program is extremely high quality, extremely smart kids, capable both artistically and academically, and it is diverse. And that made for so much richer an educational experience for all students. And I just think that the importance of making sure that our gifted programs, I would be shocked from what I have seen personally of gifted programs if the evidence doesn't show that they are highly skewed towards upper income students frankly and

[02:49:40] white students and that if that is so that we should be thinking about whether we should include a requirement that all the all the gifted programs have a plan for ensuring equitable access and that they're annually working to upgrade their plans to update their plans to ensure that they're implementing those goals um so i don't know whether dr lane whether this is the right time to do it or later but and whether or not we can do it as part of this revision or whether it fits

[02:50:14] in better somewhere else but i'm a cheerleader for our for our gifted programs and in particular for equity within our gifted programs it has so much to offer to all of our students the students from diverse backgrounds and from majority backgrounds if they can learn with with students from all backgrounds it does require them to address it in general um in terms of the um you

[02:50:45] know a section on their vision goals um but what we have found over 60 percent of the coordinators of gifted programs and school divisions do not have a background in gifted education and so To understand the data and to recognize that you have a problem is part of what we hope to do with changes we make to the annual reports so that they can see there are issues within their division and even at what grade level they seem to be having those problems because

[02:51:24] we know to find students at the lower grade levels is so important, especially for underrepresented populations. And so we're trying to make sure we have the tools in place for gifted coordinators to be able to present to their board. This is where we stand and this is how we're going to try to

[02:51:55] make change. So while they have some general requirements. Donna, you want to turn off your Janet Callahan: The objectives address multiple the address requirements for under representation in their division and certainly the tool to do that will be the annual report.

[02:52:19] John Paulin: Can I just ask Dr pollen because I have been in all the meetings that Secretary Carney had with regard to the governor school issues and was told and says it's not quite on. John Paulin: I think texting more on point than she's allowing cause.

[02:52:37] you know, the data certainly from the feeder pattern for TJ and, you know, Maggie Walker, the two sort of, you know, full-time academic governor schools is separated from Appomattox, which is a governor school of interest as opposed to, I know it's high academics, I don't mean to suggest otherwise, but the criteria for getting in is, you know, slightly different. What could we do in the context of these regs to, I mean, not just identify, because I think we've identified the problem, but to actually force a solution.

[02:53:09] And as you suggest, let's say TJ seems to say that if you're not identified and in a gifted program by third grade, you're not going to TJ. And there are, you know, if you look at the applicant pool data, you know, it's for TJ now, not for gifted stuff.

[02:53:28] But for TJ, the applicant pool is not reflective of the overall, and the gifted programs are not reflective of the overall mix, you know, demographic mix. And you know, can we through, and I know the Secretary is proposing, you know, changes to admissions policies.

[02:53:50] But if you want to address the problem at its root, which takes a little bit longer, How can we basically force divisions to have their early on gifted education programs look more like their populations?

[02:54:06] Well, we hope the combination of changing these regulations and requiring a talent developed program, which is part of what this regulation does at the earlier grades, will help force that issue of being

more representative of the underrepresented populations, in combination with the annual report to provide the data that shows they are not being, you know, representative

[02:54:45] of their community. I think part of what's been missing all along is they don't -- there's There's a lot of mathematical calculations and a lot of other things that have to be done to take the annual report as it is right now and to be able to look at those things.

[02:55:04] And when some of these coordinators are wearing, you know, 10 different hats because they're from small divisions, they don't necessarily have the time nor the background to be able to take the data as it is right now and analyze it.

[02:55:19] what we hope to do is to provide that information not only a snapshot of what's happening in that year but also trend lines over you know three years so that they can see these are the changes we're making and these this is the impact that it's having and certainly the talent development program which is part of the proposed changes is a at the younger grades is a way to find students and this forces them to have that kind of talent development program so what does that look like in a lower socioeconomic school setting

[02:55:59] elementary school setting what does and i'm sure i ought to know this but what does it mean to say we're going to do a talent development program i'm not picking on you i'm just trying to understand on the ground in the classroom, you know, is this going to make a change or is this something that looks like it's going to make a change? Those are the same kids, same parents going to push the same kids into the gifted programs, regardless of whether everybody is, you know, in the language

[02:56:31] of the proposed regs, you know, exposed to advanced and rich curricula and instruction. Well, basically, the research shows that talent development programs do make a difference for many students, especially low SES backgrounds.

[02:56:52] Claire Young: exposure to some of the kind of skill sets the critical thinking the creative thinking skill sets that you typically identify with gifted students. Claire Young: They don't have an opportunity to display those talents because they're you know showing I know these numbers, but they're not showing it in a creative sense.

[02:57:18] so a talent development program looks at kids it's not just at the very top end but maybe kids who are a little bit lower you know if you think about it maybe at the 85th percentile instead of the 95th percentile and it says let's expose these kids you know from 85th percentile and above to kinds of experiences and opportunities where they can demonstrate that they have creative

[02:57:51] thought critical thinking skills above what we normally see for that grade level say for first grade and then you you put them in that kind of environment and then you continually observe them observe for behaviors like that and there are tools out there where the research has shown very productively that these kinds of programs and these kind of teacher observations of behaviors really pull kids into gifted programs that wouldn't normally get in through just a teacher

[02:58:31] recommendation or a parent recommendation that nurturing the talent and providing opportunities for them to demonstrate talent really shine a light on the fact that these kids show potential and should be in the gifted program yeah no others had questions so i don't want to dominate this uh dr duran dr wilson dr duran oh yes thank you um a different topic um one thing that i think often happens and a group of students who often don't get identified are those students with

[02:59:07] visual or performing arts aptitude I think that's a group of students that we could do more to identify help me to understand I'm reading the across the you know the edits here help me to understand how with these revisions that would enhance more of an opportunity for those students to be identified and what is the current thinking and movement forward on how we can provide that opportunity for them again just from what i've seen over the years in education they often don't get identified in a way that i think they should be currently the way our regulations read

[02:59:43] school divisions aren't are not required to identify in visual and performing arts it's strictly up to the division and i'll have to say we don't have a lot of divisions that opt to identify in that area especially in the younger grades some of them identify and have special magnet programs for students in the arts some of them send their students to governor schools at the high school level but there are very few divisions that identify at the lower grade levels

[03:00:19] Jessica Garner: programs for the arts strictly because it it's an optional identification area for school divisions. Mark Warren: So, even with that option that school divisions have what does these revisions do to help for those that would choose that how what is a change in the revisions that i'm reading here.

[03:00:42] Jessica Garner: It doesn't it doesn't force them in any way to identify in that area and for those divisions that do identify in that area. Dr. At the lower grade levels. Again, they would still be held accountable, just like, you know, general intellectual aptitude or specific academic aptitude to to look at a diverse population.

[03:01:08] - Dr. Duran, I do believe that it also, by number one, defining what equitable representation means in the first section, and related changes throughout the document, it requires the school divisions to reflect on their representations in each of the areas that they do identify, and then further highlights ways that they can improve by looking at that data.

[03:01:37] - Thank you, Dr. Wilson. Thank you. Thinking about the question of what we're trying to accomplish, what problem are we trying to solve? It would be very helpful to me to remember or to have you all provide if there's an existing template or boilerplate that we ask divisions to complete for their annual plan. What specifically, aside from the descriptors that we have out there, is there

[03:02:10] something specific that across the commonwealth we ask all divisions to report x and y way um that would be helpful and then if we are intend if such a thing exists if we are intending to change that if there's a draft of how we are assuming the new regulations would then apply to the new boilerplate if there is such a thing so that we can we as a board are assured that as we're moving toward more equitable identification of students, that we know that we're comparing

[03:02:48] the same thing across divisions. Is that an unreasonable question or request based on what we currently have versus what we're thinking we're going toward? So the regulations require that there be an annual report, but not exactly what is in the annual report. That's up to the division i mean up to the state to require and right now we pull some numbers in terms of the

[03:03:21] areas students are identified in the ethnic and gender breakdown of those students identified and then the ethnic breakdown of the students who are referred for that year only and then and that's pulled from the end of year report um and so that that data doesn't give you a percentage it just gives you a raw number and it's it's just out there you don't you don't know if 20 students

[03:03:57] who are asian is a representative of the group in your division or not so again doctor so then Dr. Polin, the data that you pull at the state, at the department level, how is it then that if the intent is to move the, is for divisions to move the needle toward more equitable identification

[03:04:30] and services, how is it that the divisions know, certainly they set out their goals in their annual plans but so i'm what is the connection i guess between the the data pool at the state level to the annual plan and then what's the accountability measure if there is such and that may be a conversation for our next meeting but i certainly am curious about how those things from the state perspective and the board perspective speak to one another and right

[03:05:04] now i don't think they do i think the uh the divisions make their goals and um but then there's no accountability and the reason i think that is is because the annual report is very basic and doesn't really address those issues and that's why i think it's important that both the regulations require that there be an annual report and that it be presented

[03:05:36] to the board and to the community so that there will be some accountability and that annual report needs to change to provide both information in terms of comparison between what a gifted program looks like demographically and then what the division looks like demographically versus what students that are referred look like demographically and then trends over time

[03:06:10] and as well as you know basic uh program numbers and things like that so i don't think there's been that accountability because the data hasn't been um you know it's been out there that they have to do the annual report but not that they has to be presented to the boards and that it has to be presented to the community and that it's in any kind of fashion or or that you know what is in the annual report is actually some measure of accountability of of what they've done versus

[03:06:49] their goals and this and this is a great opportunity for us to look to the future and what we do need to collect and what we do need to post and how we can make it more transparent uh and and hold school divisions accountable for representation of the underrepresented groups in in their divisions so we will be looking at adding that and just to piggyback on what Michael just said to give you all a reminder about where we are in the process we're at about a step two in the sixth step regulatory process so this is your opportunity at the proposed stage before

[03:07:27] you approve it before it goes for executive branch review to really get your fingerprints on it and to work with us over the next month or two so that we get it in that final format we can certainly make changes when we get to the final stage but it's best to make those changes while we are in proposed stage right now president yes miss davis bach i would like to um i don't know if this is possible at this time but i would like to have a general idea of what each of the divisions

[03:08:02] are doing how what what are they using to identify these children and what it is what tests what measure and i'd like to just have a general consensus of of what each division is doing are they just identifying gifted children in this area or that area i'd just kind of like to get a rundown of what everybody's doing if that's possible yeah and i think we can certainly make that available to you all as well thank you so uh mr gecker if i may uh i think you're

[03:08:39] you're muted mr yes i need a zoom instruction at this late hour uh yes of course ms holton so i just like with with uh um emily's encouragement i'd like to uh uh donna obviously this draft uh does a number of things to move equity principles forward i understand the the development of the talent

development program is a that's a strong addition. I would like us when we come back next month to have some language to look at that would also add into the plan

[03:09:12] requirements a provision that local boards plans require local boards to have their plans include a provision ensuring equitable access to gifted education for diverse groups and that That plan include evaluating whether or not underrepresented groups are substantially represented in their gifted programs, and if not, plans including concrete goals for addressing those gaps.

[03:09:49] I'm just sort of making up some language as we go, and I know you all will do a wonderful job. I would like to ask if the board concurs that we ask you to develop some language like that for us to consider anyway to be added in. We can certainly do so. And Ms. Holden, if I could just add to yours, maybe, and special programs targeted at gifted students, not just the gifted program, that they're assessing these other special programs as well.

[03:10:22] Friendly amendment accepted. Okay. Anybody else on this topic? I don't see anybody. so i'd like to thank uh mr bowling and dr poland very much i know we've given you a little bit of work to do for the next meeting uh sorry about that but yeah that's part of the process to try to keep things moving and uh you know just to keep them moving forward uh and to take into account

[03:10:56] really all the aspects that we're looking to do so uh with that we will accept that one for first review and move on to item j uh mr bowling right uh in moving forward uh it's my pleasure to present to you recommendations for uh school uh recommendations for school division of innovation designations uh the 2017 general assembly approved house bill 1981 with delegate greeveson at the helm directing school virginia board of education to develop regulations for the

[03:11:32] designation of school division of innovation referred to as SDI. To be eligible for the designation a local school board would submit a plan of innovation according to the board criteria as presented in the regulations. The legislation defined innovation as a new or creative alternative to existing instructional or innovative practices or school structures that evidence-based practice suggest would be effective in improving student learning and educational performance each school

[03:12:08] division recommended the designation recommended for the designation have will have a plan of innovation to improve student learning educational performance and college and career and citizenship readiness skills in one or more schools for the benefit of all the schools in their division school division applications for the sdi designation were evaluated by teams of videoe staff based on a rubric as is detailed in the full board item document. Based on these evaluations, 15 school divisions are being recommended for approval by the board for designation as a school

[03:12:47] division of innovation. And those school divisions include Buchanan, Goochland, Hampton City, Henrico, Hopewell City, Loudon, Middlesex, Montgomery, Pocosin City, Roanoke County, Salem City, Stanton City, Virginia Beach City, West Point, and York County Public Schools.

[03:13:14] The board item before you provides a sample of each school division's initiatives that have assisted them in their educational innovation. And the Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education waive first review and approve the designation of school division of innovation to the recommended school divisions okay uh any questions on this item thank you mr bowling i do not see any uh is there a motion on this since we've been asked to

[03:13:54] wait first review and move forward so move to wait first review and move forward thank you dr duran is there a second second thank you dr wilson i will do this by roll call miss davis Miss Follett? Aye.

[03:14:10] Dr. Duran? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Dr. Pexton? Aye. Dr. Wilson?

[03:14:25] Aye. And I vote aye. Okay. Well, thank you very much, Mr. Bowling. Thank you very much. All right. Presentations. The SEAC annual report, Dr. Hollins, Christine Germeyer, and Jill Sowers.

[03:14:41] Welcome. Thank you so much, President Gecker, and good afternoon, President Gecker, Vice President Wilson, members of the board, and Dr. Lane. It is my pleasure to be here with you today, along with my director of the Office of Special Education Facilities and Family Engagement, Mr. Hank Millward, and our illustrious chairs of your state special education advisory committee.

[03:15:04] We're joined today by both Christine Germeier, who is the SEAC chair, as well as Jill Sowers-Becker, who is our SEAC vice chair. I'm going to go ahead and turn it over to them. As I can see, Emily's been kind enough to load our presentation, but just a reminder that this presentation is for you from your advisory board and the superintendent recommends that the board receive this presentation and report and its recommendations as it moves forward to create sound policies for student success specifically as they relate to students with disabilities and with that i will hand it over to christine and jill's very capable hands thank you dr hollins

[03:15:39] good afternoon president gecker vice president dr wilson dr lane and honorable members of the board It is my pleasure to join you today alongside my colleague and Vice Chair Jill Sowers and of course with the support of Dr. Hollins, Mr. Millward, and their teams to bring you the State Special Education Advisory Committee's annual report for July 2019 through June 2020.

[03:16:02] While this virtual platform allows for each of us to join from the comfort of our homes and reduces the burden of traveling, it has created a host of challenges for students with disabilities, their families, teachers, related service providers, and administrators in Virginia.

[03:16:19] Emily, next slide, please. The State Special Education Advisory Committee, or as we refer to ourselves, State SEAC, serves the Commonwealth by advising VDOE of unmet needs within the Commonwealth in the education of children with disabilities, commenting publicly on any rules or regulations proposed by the Commonwealth regarding the education of children with disabilities, advising videoe in developing evaluations and reporting on data to the secretary of education under section 618 of the act advising videoe in developing corrective action plans to address

[03:16:57] findings identified in federal monitoring reports under part b of the act and advising videoe in developing and implementing policies relating to the coordination of services for children with disabilities idea clearly states that our role is in an advisory capacity only but we rely on input from citizens, constituency groups, and 23 stakeholders that include parents, teachers, related service providers, state agency representatives, administrators, and people with disabilities. We have five subcommittees that include executive, nominating, policy and regulations, student achievement and student outcomes, and our family engagement and community

[03:17:37] outreach. Up until March of 2020, the four meetings were held in Richmond. Next slide, please. public comments are carefully considered by the committee as we develop the annual plan and recommendations for the board of education we received a number of public comments this year the three listed on this slide represent common themes that were identified as we began to put together those

recommendations they are the eligibility process discipline expulsion suspension and the over-representation of certain groups such as low-income african-american students students

[03:18:15] with disabilities and immigrant students and the overall representation of students with disabilities in foster care next slide please we also take a close look at constituency reports when preparing our recommendations common themes included teacher shortage concerns retention pay burnout recruitment support early student training on post-secondary options and considerations as well as transition for all students parent and community involvement critical decision points for students with disabilities, least restrictive environment as it relates to inclusion,

[03:18:53] CSA funding and regional training centers, and discipline restraint and seclusion. Next slide, please. The committee identifies specific topics throughout the year for presentations.

[03:19:10] These topics are generally generated by issues surrounding public comments, constituency reports, input from BDOE, and subcommittee discussions. We had about 20 presentations this year all of which are referenced in the full report that was provided to you to highlight just a few students with disabilities discipline data review transition university and inclusion project updates the jlark audit briefing and pre-employment transition services next slide the state cac wishes to acknowledge the herculean measures that were undertaken by

[03:19:48] both the virginia board of education and the virginia department of education after schools across the commonwealth were closed under executive order 53 for the remainder of the 2019 2020 school year during the pandemic video we worked tirelessly to produce and provide a variety of resources and information through its website they maintained regular communications with local school divisions they advocated for waivers at the federal level and they continually updated a covet 19 faqs page to keep families informed video invested in initiatives to develop online resources that

[03:20:25] promoted total inclusive school programming and made available the virtual virginia platform free to teachers the efforts of the virginia department of education virginia board of education and the virginia secretary of education have not gone unnoticed by the state cac the state cac would like to recognize and thank the assistant superintendent of special education and student Services, Dr. Samantha Hollins and her team for for keeping children with disabilities a priority during the closure and commend the Board of Education and the Department of Education on the following accomplishments of this past administrative year listed before you.

[03:21:04] Jill. Multiple workgroups and task forces who address safety, learning, and the return to school for children across the Commonwealth, implementing the option to sign up for information updates from the gov delivery system where Virginia Department of Education shared instructional resources, professional development, support, and information for families directly with stakeholders. Next slide. Purchasing virtual job shadowing license for school systems to use at no cost for students with disabilities. Parent education advocacy training centers

[03:21:42] transition university platform which is designed to educate families, teachers, and self-advocates available opportunities and resources for students transitioning to postsecondary-like. Next slide.

[03:21:58] Prior to COVID-19 closing schools, the state SEAC had identified the continuing need to improve opportunities for students with disabilities to be educated alongside their peers without

disabilities in the least restrictive environment. The state SEAC had looked more closely at discipline data among students with disabilities and more notable, the disproportionate discipline towards students of color with disabilities.

[03:22:22] The state SEAC identified the need to support the whole child by providing social emotional learning and improving family engagement, which in our current environment is extremely important. It will take significant funding for Virginia's public education system to be adequate while ensuring that every student, including students with disabilities, has an equal opportunity to become a high performing life ready citizen.

[03:22:47] The pandemic has clearly exacerbated existing inequities within the Commonwealth. Students with disabilities, English language learners, students of color, low income families and limited internet access household are among the most marginalized populations.

[03:23:04] Learning was significantly altered due to the school closures and highlighted challenges for students with disabilities and their parents, families and caregivers engaging in and for school divisions providing virtual education and supports. As school divisions begin the new school year, there is still much that needs considered when addressing the needs of all students more equitably.

[03:23:26] Students with disabilities must continue to remain a priority as schools return to learning. Based on the above observations, public comments, reports from members representing their constituency groups, and other information presented to the committee, the STATSEAC makes the following recommendations to the Board of Education.

[03:23:46] First, continue efforts to address the teacher staff and other professional support shortages by exploring available funding resources and partnerships, reviewing teacher licensure and application process that is cost review time and practice requirements.

[03:24:02] Investigating the release of grant awards prior to the fall semester for students enrolled in teacher preparation college courses, pursuing innovative partnerships with institutes of higher. education and local school divisions, and support of early career professionals to attain licensure, support retention, and provide highly qualified professional development and technical assistance.

[03:24:25] These endeavors will facilitate the expansion of programs like the Journey into Teaching Academy, which currently focuses on new teachers maintaining their license and staying in place. Next slide. Second, provide local school divisions with additional resources and support needed to further promote social emotional learning and enhance connections for students and families created through existing initiatives such as social emotional standard developments grants and partnerships between community mental health providers and local school divisions to

[03:25:00] build school-based mental health programs virginia tiered systems of support and promoting behavioral health design these services need to be developed with the focus on ensuring that students and families can access them in person or through virtual learning alternatives. Next slide.

[03:25:18] Third, continue initiatives by supporting the development of online resources that promote total inclusive school programming and more in-depth training for school personnel that cover special education regulations to include transition, targeted specifically for school building administrators. Transition being beginning in elementary through post-secondary choices, advanced online modules for dyslexia that go into more detail than the current module required for teacher licensure critical decision

modules in other languages and fourth support efforts of higher education by encouraging partnerships and expanding programs

[03:25:57] that make permanent the focus on universal design that are that has been required in the covet 19 pandemic next slide please the statesiac appreciates the opportunity to present these recommendations your commitment to make good on the promise of a high quality education for every child by eliminating racial and socioeconomic inequities in virginia's public education system is commendable we recognize that the impacts of the pandemic have put an exhaustive strain on everyone we have had to adapt and been asked to become more flexible as we watch the

[03:26:35] equity gap widen but we remain hopeful that as you are doing your work you will keep students with disabilities a priority by considering and implementing the recommendations as deemed appropriate without delay. We look forward to working alongside the Virginia Department of Education and the Board of Education to improve outcomes for students with disabilities in the Commonwealth. Once again, I thank you for the privilege of your time today, and I am happy to receive any questions you may have.

[03:27:12] Okay, unmuted now. Thank you very much for hanging in for a particularly long meeting and for providing us the information you just did and your advice. Are there any questions by board members regarding the report?

[03:27:35] I am not seeing any, is that right? - Yes, thank you. We really appreciate it. And we know our special ed parents in particular, it's a real struggle to hang in there. And I know everybody wants to be back in class, in person as normal as we can be, as soon as we can be.

[03:27:52] And I know you all have been struggling and I appreciate your kind words for the department their efforts to struggle along with you and i know our our school boards and school divisions are there too it's tough times thank you thank you thank you okay uh so again thanks very much uh we have uh two written reports and i guess we're now down to discussion of current issues i think uh you know last meeting we talked about dr lane talking about the state of virtual learning uh james there you are uh you ready to do this and then we can have discussions as people want

[03:28:31] go ahead thank you and i um i may try to share my screen if i'm allowed emily yep you should be able to and of course the visual i was going to show you just reloaded so hopefully this will load in a second but on our honors our website uh we have created a state snapshot of how virginia schools are reopening and what you will see is that uh around 50 percent of our school districts

[03:29:06] are in a fully remote model actually just above 50 percent and then uh the remainder of our school districts are doing uh some type of hybrid or in person we um we updated this on september 8th since september 8th we've heard from a lot of school divisions that are starting to transition to more of a hybrid approach um i've spent a significant amount of time over the last couple weeks since schools opened for everybody even though many started well over a month ago.

[03:29:35] Visiting schools that are open for in-person instruction and a school division that was open for virtual instruction where they're having their teachers teach from the building and have gotten to learn a lot about what's going on. We have heard from school districts that had some hiccups on the first day and technology and internet issues but as time has gone on that has seemed to smooth out. We have nearly 110 school divisions partnering with us directly

[03:30:09] through the expansion of the Virtual Virginia program. You may be aware that we're essentially working on four projects with Virtual Virginia. The first is the traditional project that they provide and that is to provide internet-based instruction in a synchronous way with a teacher provided by the virtual virginia program several of our school divisions are using our teachers in that program which is actually housed from a fiscal standpoint in charlotte county to deliver

[03:30:43] direct instruction to their students we also uh as part of the outreach program expanded virtual virginia to essentially allow any school division to enroll their teachers and students to deliver their instruction through our platform uh and and uh you know an overwhelming number of school divisions are are are doing that now as well uh and also in virtual virginia we are creating uh content k-12 so that when teachers are teaching in a virtual setting they have readily accessible materials that they can use to instruct uh and those materials are are rolling out constantly

[03:31:19] and a majority of those materials were rolled out just before the beginning of school year and a project that we're working on now that is not launched yet is we are also developing uh K-12 completely asynchronous instruction modules and courses that can be delivered in school divisions where synchronous instruction is not possible. We certainly know that in many of our communities internet access for students is not reliable and so the governor granted as part of the GEAR fund nearly 18 million dollars well we're going to grant that money in about two weeks but

[03:32:00] we held an application process to release that 18 million dollars and are getting ready to release those uh funds to school divisions now which are primarily in the applications going to be used for the purchase of devices and my files and other things to support internet infrastructure and homes the governor also set aside nearly 10 million dollars that will go to the virginia broadband initiative for more of those long-term type projects that will bring permanent and stable internet uh to communities um and so uh we have found that our teachers over the last few months

[03:32:34] have created incredible resources have been great have gained incredible new skills uh and uh overwhelmingly the school divisions that are doing a virtual solution uh well let me say a remote solution are doing that primarily virtually but some of our students that lack that access are having to do some of their work asynchronously and this ties into the conversation that we had yesterday around hours where recognizing that issue we did provide the flexibility to school districts even though we did not waive the hours requirement for core instruction even though we gave them a pathway to waiving their overall number hours uh we we did make it clear that

[03:33:11] that could be done in any mode whether that be in-person hybrid synchronous or asynchronous uh so that school divisions can had the flexibility to meet the needs of students based on the realities in the community as of today. We've also partnered again with our Virginia public media stations and are offering television-based instruction and in grade bands that can be accessible in the afternoons. Most of the TV stations, in fact, BPM, kudos to them,

[03:33:47] they took their entire second channel you know they had wcve east and west i think e and w and the entire second channel is now uh focused on instructional programming so that that was really nice um and so that's a high level overview i can certainly go into much more depth or specific questions um uh but uh this nate state snapshot if you go to our website is is great when you hover over it not only will it tell you um the division name and the number of students enrolled but

[03:34:20] but the exact uh method of their implementation um you can also scroll over the the key factors here such as in person and it'll give you the full list of school divisions that are going in person uh to build transparency around it and you can see that populate as i hover over each of the components. And let me say also just a thanks to Yun Mo and Jen Piper-Renna and Dave Myers on our data team for putting together this great graphic to help people around the Commonwealth know what's

[03:34:55] going on. Okay, thank you. Are there any questions? Okay, Ms. Holton. Thank you. If you could stop sharing the screen so I can have the larger boxes again, I'd appreciate it.

[03:35:11] It's hard for me to see this. Thank you. Thank you, Dr. Lane, for your and your colleagues' heroic efforts and I know we have teachers and school boards across the commonwealth that's been making heroic efforts to make virtual learning work. As you know we've heard from a large volume of the public public comment and certainly in conversations more generally and uh and we know that there are many students for whom virtual education will just never be an adequate substitute for in-person education. I'd be interested in what is the department doing to partner with the

[03:35:47] divisions who figure out when and how we can safely return to more in-person you know what are we doing to learn from the divisions that are more in-person status what's working what's not what are we doing to learn from other states and other countries what information we make available to school boards to enable them to as quickly as safely possible to more in-person instruction i do think i'm in a lot of divisions have made fairly temporary decisions with i hope that will someday and obviously a lot of it depends on community transmission

[03:36:26] and items that are beyond the control of any of us but what are we doing to be sure our part is ready when the community transfer rates get down uh well thank you of course we've provided extensive guidance on on how to uh implement any of those strategies but the virginia department of health did create a document during phase three to guide school divisions and how to determine their community transmission rates and then based on those community transmission rates they identified which methodology of learning would be most appropriate. I think it's important

[03:37:04] to note what you said is absolutely true that whereas virtual learning is a solution to continue kids education it does not replace the benefits of in-person learning and so in the um vdh's recommendations essentially if a school division is in the highest level of transmission you know we we recommend a more cautious approach and in that case recommend that maybe only special education students be served in person but it's important to note that in the vdh's recommendations that there's really no community transmission level where we would say that our special

[03:37:43] education students wouldn't be given access to those programs. Ultimately, these are decisions by the school boards, and many school boards have not begun implementing in-person instruction, but even in the highest transmission level, VDH recommends that. In the second, what we would call moderate transmission level, we then begin to recommend that if a community is in moderate transmission that continuing to serve students with disabilities, but also to begin serving English language learners and pre-K through three and our youngest learners. In the lowest

[03:38:16] transmission level where there is community transmission, but it's low, that's when we recommend really moving to that full hybrid model where students are at least getting partial in-person instruction during the week. And when there's no community transmission, obviously that's when we would recommend a full implementation. It's important to note that the CDC just two days ago put out

their guidance on community transmission levels in school implementation, and whereas there are some differences, and the VDH is working through that overall, our plan that we outlined

[03:38:55] there, and this is new guidance for school divisions, does seem to be on the whole in alignment with CDC with some some needed tweaks that we'll make over the coming weeks. We have also provided to the community health directors a dashboard to help with assisting them in providing information to school districts so that they can best determine their community transmission level.

[03:39:21] In addition to that we continue up until this week to meet with our superintendents on a frequent basis. We met every week pretty much until the first day of school. We gave them that day off from meeting with us. We met again this week and now we're going to move actually to transition to to meet with them monthly on an on an as-needed basis as they work through their plans. But we've we've begun encouraging our school districts to now that schools are open whether it's virtual, hybrid, or in person to make sure that they're formulating plans for that next step to move

[03:39:55] either from virtual or hybrid or hybrid to in person or vice versa based on their transmission level, and we've seen some positive movement in this. Chesterfield is the largest district where we've seen this. The Chesterfield superintendent announced this week that their health committee has recommended an in-person start for special education students at the end of September.

[03:40:22] Their early learners will begin coming back in mid-October, and many of the other grades will come back in late October and November, and so we are seeing school divisions transition in a in a phased way, but with a movement towards getting more in-person instruction.

[03:40:38] So if I may just, you all have done a great job of getting a lot of guidance, and I understand school divisions have been very cautious and understand why they've been cautious. Teachers, educators, leaders, everybody, families are cautious and nervous about going back.

[03:40:56] But to the extent we can now, we've got a range of options as you see from that map. we do have divisions that have moved forward uh in a more in-person way we should be taking and as you say we've got some large divisions starting to do that with chesterfield stepping up soon hopefully but with with the department of health you all can be helping learn lessons from those divisions of is it working and what's working better than what's working what's working better what's working worse and then help share within an ongoing you know because we learn new things every day about this virus we're learning things from the european countries that have

[03:41:38] in-person instruction and some good lessons and some cautionary tales so i hope that you will continue to help make that information robustly available and assume a leadership role thank you and and yeah i answered many parts of your question but i didn't answer that part we we do continue to do that we're providing the the latest information And frankly, in our weekly calls with superintendents, we've been highlighting school districts that have been opening in-person and sharing some of the strategies that have been really successful.

[03:42:13] And so we will continue to do that work with superintendents as well. - Thank you. - Anybody else have any questions? Dr. Mann and then Dr. Wilson. - Yes, thank you so much for that, Dr. Lane.

[03:42:28] And I guess I'd like to add an element maybe where there's room to provide more support. Because I do think the virtual reality is going to be a part of what we're having to contend with, regardless

of when and how we can get certain populations back into schools or more fully open based on what's going on in the community.

[03:42:52] And I guess I just wonder if there are ways to to offer up models of of the level of intensity of screen time as a component of the virtual reality that might invite more comfort with appreciating that a mapping of a school day onto a virtual experience can really be overwhelming.

[03:43:25] and taxing, especially for very young children. And I don't know if there are ways to kind of open that up, even for older students. You think about their transition into a college program and the idea that everything feels exactly like being in school.

[03:43:45] I just, I offer that up as a way to also have us be creative thinking about how we can support schools in that element because the intensity of screen experience as the modality it's just I do worry about that I worry about that especially for very young children and the science around just the impact of that on you know brain development and such so I just

[03:44:23] offered that as something to to think about yeah thank you Dr. Mann and actually I appear to be oddly frozen in the video side of this but the Michael because for fears that I'm so frozen I can't do this maybe you will pop our new virtual learning website on the screen if you have that readily available but Dr. Mann we agree with you completely we gave we created a website that we gave school division guidance on best practices and virtual learning and limiting screen time.

[03:44:56] I will tell you early in that process we actually created a document that put caps or recommended hours on that and the school division leadership vehemently objected to having that specificity out there because they wanted flexibility and so we went instead with this website that does guide them on best practices and making sure that they understand that five and a half hours of screen time is not appropriate especially for our youngest learners and uh and to make sure that they're doing a mixture of synchronous and asynchronous and project-based opportunities

[03:45:36] to continue students learning and not just all screen time and i i don't know if michael is still there but um if uh i what i will do is make sure to email you the link to our virtual website that provides that guidance thank you dr lane i do have the um site on the screen and then i also just dropped the link to it in the chat thank you michael okay great neither of those are populating for me so i appreciate it okay uh dr wilson or dr man were you finished i'm sorry okay dr wilson

[03:46:10] thank you president gecker actually with the um reference to the website or the landing page uh and the link i think my question will be answered it was about professional development and supports for teachers but i think i'll find what i'm looking for at those two resources so thanks uh dr pexton yeah just uh curious i was just scanning the link real quick so i haven't had a chance to answer my own question possibly but you know just from personal experience a lot of empathy data i'm getting back on other parents is there

[03:46:46] a section on there on how we are supporting parents because i'm getting a lot of you know from my own engagement with a six-year-old and who i'm working with daycare that we still work with uh you know a lot of parents are are either um you know explicitly not engaging because they don't they never had to to this level and they it's just not natural or they just don't know how you know they're you know the scramble to figure out how to get the google classroom last week just ridiculous for so many people so anyway i'm just curious what that looks like as far as really

[03:47:24] trying to because that's a big part of this so yeah no thank you thank you for the question then i'll turn it over to michael but um the what i what i will share is that uh we have seen obviously a huge increase in parent engagement in general uh with with parents being more and more involved than ever because uh they have to be and i i hope that's a component that we can continue even after this has done uh recognizing that each school division's model and the way they've built it is unique um the the plans for how they're educating parents really come from them because the the

[03:47:59] platforms they use may not be ours so on and so forth uh but our our 3r document our major guidance document on how to reopen in this way provides information on how to communicate with families but i'll turn it over to michael to provide additional details yes uh it with throughout this document we do reference connecting with parents on things like from that range from how to use or access a learning management system all the way to how to set up the home environment

[03:48:32] for conducive to student learning and also about how to communicate and access teachers and for technical support as well and so throughout this document it references talking not only to training students but also to training parents and in addition we have a number of resources through student services on supporting parents through in virtual learning and other learning

[03:49:04] modalities great thank you okay James I guess let me just ask you know you and I have had a lot of conversation about how do we ensure quality in the virtual instruction and you know we touched upon it briefly yesterday during that call and that sort of ties into my mind to what are the department's current expectations with regard to outcomes for this year what i mean by that yeah thank you

[03:49:39] you know when we started this you know you and i were talking in march and you know when nobody knew how long term this was going to be you know the discussion was basically uh you know how are we going to make up the time we missed for the you know last school year you know are we going to do it at the end we're going to do summer we're going to do uh acceleration in the fall and then it became our conversations as this grew on how are we going to support our kids as they come back to school uh and the trauma that has been you know inflicted upon them by you know going through the virtual part and the you know sort of lack of school for the end of the last school year

[03:50:18] now we're in sort of you know i wouldn't say fully virtual but we are in a substantially virtual environment with, you know, significantly disparate capability of providing virtual education in that environment, you know, between divisions and frankly within divisions.

[03:50:36] I think, you know, I get asked a lot actually, you know, what are we expecting? You know, you get, I get an email a day about, you know, are we going to test? But the real question there is, are we expected to do well on the tests? Where do we think we're going? And I am still very concerned about you know and i know the answer always is it's up to the locals but there's got to be something from our level that says this is an expectation of the quality level of the virtual these are the checkpoints we're going to have during the year because again from the call

[03:51:15] yesterday waiting till the end might work for certain you know divisions but it's not going to work uniformly and you know we seem to continually leave behind the same set of people uh you know of kids what are we doing here and what do you expect and what can the board do and we talked about asking for reports on the formative assessments what can we actually do to get a better idea of how we're tracking and where we need to focus a lot of attention before the end

[03:51:47] of year test uh thank you i i will make sure to send to the board um there's there's three parts to this answer i'll make sure to send to the board the memo or email that we sent to school divisions on how they might qualify for a 990 clock hour waiver.

[03:52:05] But one of the things that we put within that is that they are required to submit periodic reports to the board on how their students are doing and then based on the feedback that we got from you and the vice president, also on their professional development and what they're doing to work with their teachers.

[03:52:25] Second component of that, which will be included with that, is we are preparing to grant money to the school districts per the ESSER set-aside to ensure that school divisions have diagnostic assessments that can be used for this purpose. The school divisions are actually in a process now of having those assessments vetted through an alignment process to make sure that the assessments that they're choosing for diagnostic purposes are aligned to the standards of learning and your assessments. And then third component as you mentioned is more summative and that is that The Secretary of Education for the nation has made it very clear that there will not be waivers on

[03:53:05] the federally required components of the assessment system. Therefore, we do not anticipate that any of the SOLs will be canceled this year as they were last year. But I think that we're developing now what we will expect divisions to submit in these periodic reports, but certainly if there are specific components of that that the board would like, we'll take your feedback now and make sure that's a part of it i appreciate that i i mean if you've sent me that document i apologize i have not seen it or at least not read it the one use but i appreciate the follow-through

[03:53:43] greatly on the conversations that you dr wilson and i had with regard to uh you know the reporting back and it would be helpful if we you know got that you know as they came into the department so we could see where where we are and address it soon as opposed to waiting absolutely we will we'll get that memo to you right away and certainly seek your feedback on any other components you'd like the memo the link to the memo is in the chat i just saw that thanks does that mean i saw it

[03:54:18] previously and just didn't read it mr gecker i don't know for certain and uh and so uh well i apologize if i did but i don't i don't think i've seen this before we president gecker we did share an early draft with you you may not have the absolute final final version um but i'll also send it out to the full board to your email just so you have it there as well yeah thank you all right anybody else with uh current issues or topics or uh questions for you know james or

[03:54:56] anybody else who's still on this call i have one yes separate issue so i want me to wait if anyone else has any on that issue or no i think we're good thanks francisco i know our time is going long i'm just going to make sure that i recognize that we started and we're currently as you can see with my background in hispanic heritage month was started on september 15th and goes to october 15th i just want to make sure we recognize and honor that um we know and we honored it last year that we have over 200 000 hispanic and latino youth in our virginia public schools and so this

[03:55:32] is a time for us to honor and recognize um the diversity of our of our commonwealth and the contributions to the cultural fabric of Virginia and all the different complexities of the Hispanic Latino history that's contributed to our own history here in Virginia. So I just want to take the time to recognize and that's why I put up my background today of Hispanic Heritage Month which goes through October

15th. Thank you Mr. President. I appreciate that very much Dr. Duran. I remember when you read the resolution in Spanish last year, I'm now on day 416 of Duolingo. I was hoping you

[03:56:08] would do it again this year so I could see how far I've come Spanish knowledge so but thank you anybody else if not I guess it is time to adjourn I will say it is still some sadness for me when we have these meetings that we can't see each other in person and signing off on zoom does not seem like the same as you know walking out of the building and you know getting the last goodbyes so uh for all of you i hope we get to see each other soon uh thank you very much for spending

[03:56:44] you know the couple of days and the the work that has been put in to get to these couple of days and you know james and everybody else at doe uh we clearly recognize all of us recognize uh the stress that the current environment has created uh you know we tend to i think maybe maybe just i tend to you know feel that stress on me and think well it's just me but there is a that you know recognition that the stress that every parent feels today is you know multiplied when you are basically

[03:57:21] trying to help all the parents in the commonwealth see their kids through their education program in a way that none of us anticipated what we would be having today so for all the work that you and the department has done you know we really genuinely thank you uh and i hope uh you take some time you know all of you take a little bit of time to sit back reflect de-stress and then come back and you know we'll do it again so thank you all so much and uh we'll see you next month if not sooner thank you thanks everybody goodbye everyone goodbye



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